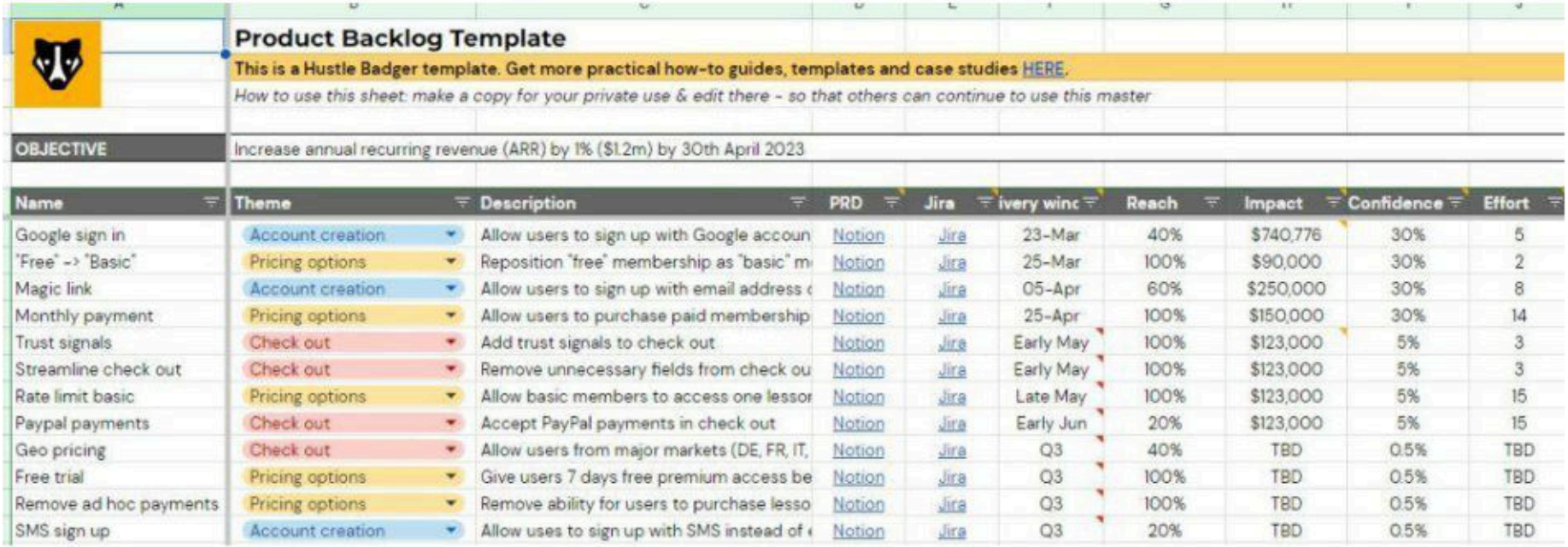
The Role of Product Manager in UX Design

A Product Manager is **not responsible for designing screens**, but is **responsible for the quality of experience**.

1. Define the user problem clearly
2. Bring user insights and context into decisions
3. Set UX success metrics (conversion, completion, etc.)
4. Prioritize simple and intuitive experiences over complexity
5. Collaborate with designers by giving context, not designs
6. Validate UX using data, feedback, and user behavior

The Product Manager's ultimate role in the design stage is to collaborate with designers with respect to the queries they will have regarding the user story.

What is a User Story?



Product Backlog Template

This is a Hustle Badger template. Get more practical how-to guides, templates and case studies HERE.

How to use this sheet: make a copy for your private use & edit there - so that others can continue to use this master

OBJECTIVE	Increase annual recurring revenue (ARR) by 1% ($1.2m) by 30th April 2023

Name	Theme	Description	PRD	Jira	ivery winc	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort
Google sign in	Account creation	Allow users to sign up with Google accoun	Notion	Jira	23-Mar	40%	$740,776	30%	5
"Free" -> "Basic"	Pricing options	Reposition "free" membership as "basic" m	Notion	Jira	25-Mar	100%	$90,000	30%	2
Magic link	Account creation	Allow users to sign up with email address	Notion	Jira	05-Apr	60%	$250,000	30%	8
Monthly payment	Pricing options	Allow users to purchase paid membership	Notion	Jira	25-Apr	100%	$150,000	30%	14
Trust signals	Check out	Add trust signals to check out	Notion	Jira	Early May	100%	$123,000	5%	3
Streamline check out	Check out	Remove unnecessary fields from check ou	Notion	Jira	Early May	100%	$123,000	5%	3
Rate limit basic	Pricing options	Allow basic members to access one lesso	Notion	Jira	Late May	100%	$123,000	5%	15
Paypal payments	Check out	Accept PayPal payments in check out	Notion	Jira	Early Jun	20%	$123,000	5%	15
Geo pricing	Check out	Allow users from major markets (DE, FR, IT,	Notion	Jira	Q3	40%	TBD	0.5%	TBD
Free trial	Pricing options	Give users 7 days free premium access be	Notion	Jira	Q3	100%	TBD	0.5%	TBD
Remove ad hoc payments	Pricing options	Remove ability for users to purchase lesso	Notion	Jira	Q3	100%	TBD	0.5%	TBD
SMS sign up	Account creation	Allow uses to sign up with SMS instead of	Notion	Jira	Q3	20%	TBD	0.5%	TBD

What is a User Story?

A user story is a description of a feature/functionality written from the user's point of view, explaining what they want, why they want it and how success will be measured. It contain below sections:

1. **The Story**
2. **Acceptance Criteria (Very Important):** Defines when the feature is considered "done".
3. **Success Metrics:** How you measure if this feature is successful.
4. **Edge Cases:** Scenarios that might break the experience.
5. **Business Impact:** Why this matters for the company.

What is a User Story?

1. **The Story**

   As a user, I want to save my delivery address, so that I can checkout faster next time.

2. **Acceptance Criteria (Very Important):** Defines when the feature is considered “done”.

   - User can add a new address
   - User can edit/delete saved addresses
   - Address is auto-filled during checkout
   - Validation for required fields (PIN, city, etc.)
   - User should have option to add New Address in the checkout page

3. **Success Metrics:** How you measure if this feature is successful.

   - % of users saving an address
   - Reduction in checkout time
   - Increase in checkout conversion rate

4. **Edge Cases:** Scenarios that might break the experience.

   - Invalid PIN code
   - Duplicate address
   - No internet connection

5. **Business Impact:** Why this matters for the company.

   - Faster checkout → higher conversion
   - Better experience → higher retention

The Goal of this module

1. Explain what UX Design is?
2. Give a brief about the different components of UX Design
3. Make you aware of the processes, UX Designer goes through while creating the experiences
4. Make you aware of the lingos Designer use so that you as a PM can have effective communication with Designer
5. Give a brief overview of the different tools used by Designer such as figma, miro, user testing etc. so that you can collaborate with them effectively

Important: This module will make you sufficiently equipped with design tools and techniques — without turning you into a designer!

What are your expectation from this session?

If you still insist to become a UX Designer, you will need master these

1. **Universal Design Principles:** (Color Psychology, Layout and Composition, Typeface, White Space Mgmt. etc.)
2. **Design Thinking & UX Process:** (Method in the madness, From problem → solution → validation)
3. **Human Psychology & Usability:** (How human think, decide, and/or make mistakes)
4. **UX Laws & Heuristics:** (Why some designs feel intuitive and others frustrating)
5. **Technology Understanding:** (What can actually be built, and how systems behave)
6. **Foundations of Interaction & Experience Design:** (Flows, journeys, edge cases, states)

And most importantly… Relentless Practice, Practice and Practice for years

Sample PM Question on UX Design

1. How would you improve the user experience of a product you use daily?
2. Design a food delivery app for Tier-2 cities.
3. Design a vending machine for Blind People
4. How would you improve onboarding for a new SaaS product?
5. Design a feature for WhatsApp to improve group conversations.

Here is the framework to answer these question:

Design Thinking + Product Thinking + Metrics

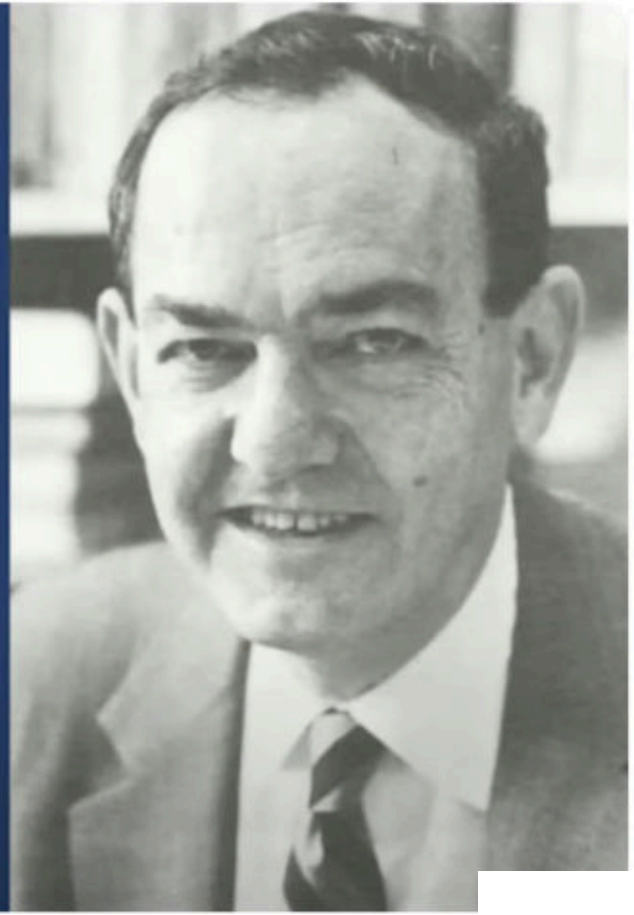
1. Define the user (Empathize)
2. Define the problem (Define)
3. Explore solutions (Ideate)
4. Prioritize (RICE)
5. Define success metrics

Who is the greatest designer ever?

1. What is Design?

> To design is to devise courses of action aimed at changing existing situation into preferred.

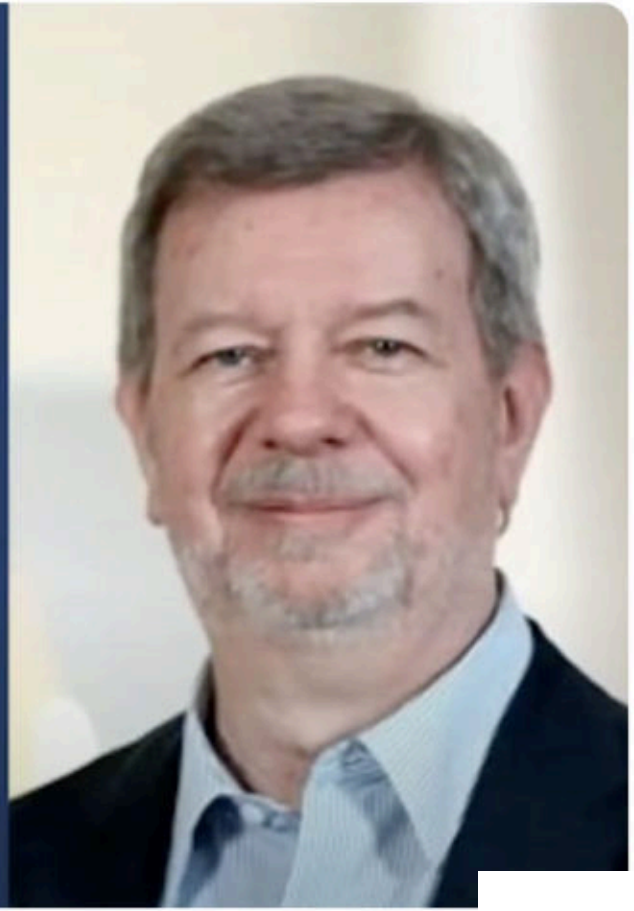
– Herbert A. Simon
American Political Scientist. Winner of Turing Award, 1975



1. What is Design?

"Design is conception and planning of the artificial"

– Richard Buchanan
Professor of Design, Weatherhead School of Management



1. What is Design?

"Design... participates in the making of a new culture, from spoon to city."

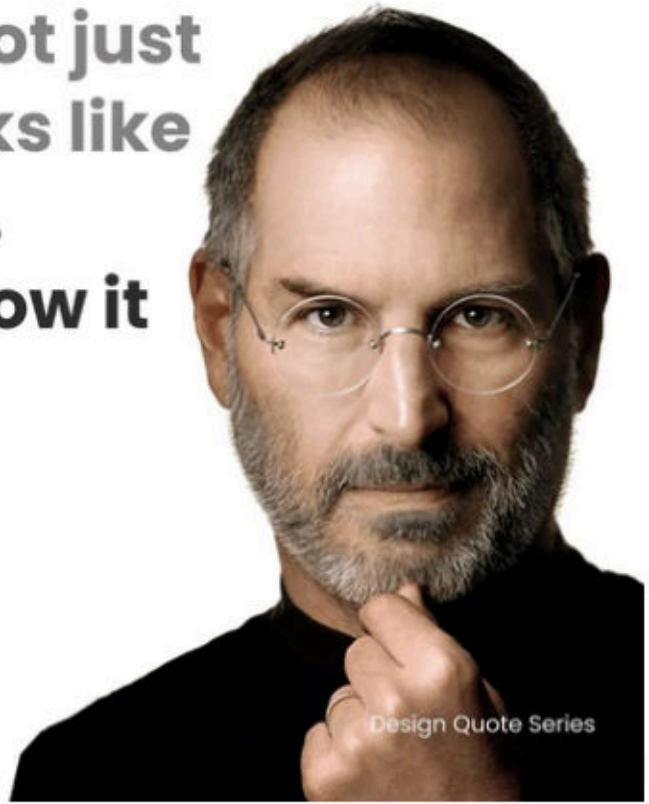
– Max Bill
Swiss Architect, Industrial designer and Graphic designer



Design is not just what it looks like & feels like.
Design is how it works.

- Steve Jobs
Entrepreneur, Industrial Designer,
Co-founder & CEO of Apple

#WhatisDesign #DefineDesign



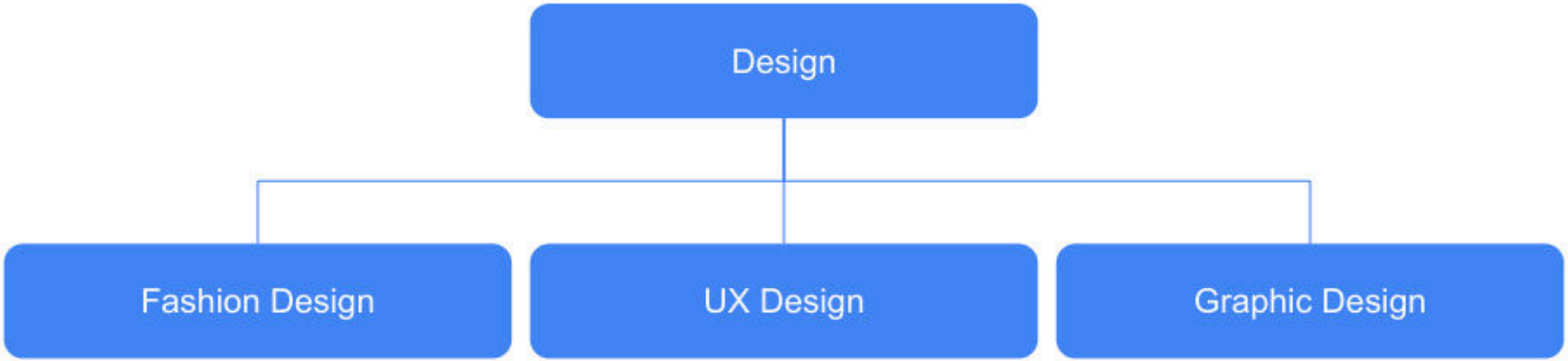
What is Design?

1. Design is all about finding the best solutions to the problem
2. Design is far far more than the look and feel
3. Design is both art and science

3 Key components of Design



What is UX Design?



“UX Design is a process of creating experiences which are effective, efficient, easy and enjoyable.”

Example

Say uber want to create a feature using which their users will be able to book buses as well



Example

UX Design is a process of creating ***experience*** *which are effective, efficient, easy and enjoyable.*

The complete journey of Booking a seat is an experience



Example

*UX Design is a process of creating experience which are **effective**, efficient, easy and enjoyable.*

To make sure that **users can easily find and book the seats**



Example

UX Design is a process of creating experience which are effective, ***efficient****, easy and enjoyable.*

To make sure that **users can book the seat quickly**



Example

UX Design is a process of creating experience which are effective, efficient, ***easy*** *and enjoyable.*

To make sure that **the interface is easy simple, clean and easy to understand and navigate**



Example

UX Design is a process of creating experience which are effective, efficient, easy and ***enjoyable****.*

To make sure that **the complete journey of booking is enjoyable**



Example

*UX Design is a **process** of creating experience which are effective, efficient, easy and enjoyable.*

But what about the process??



Example

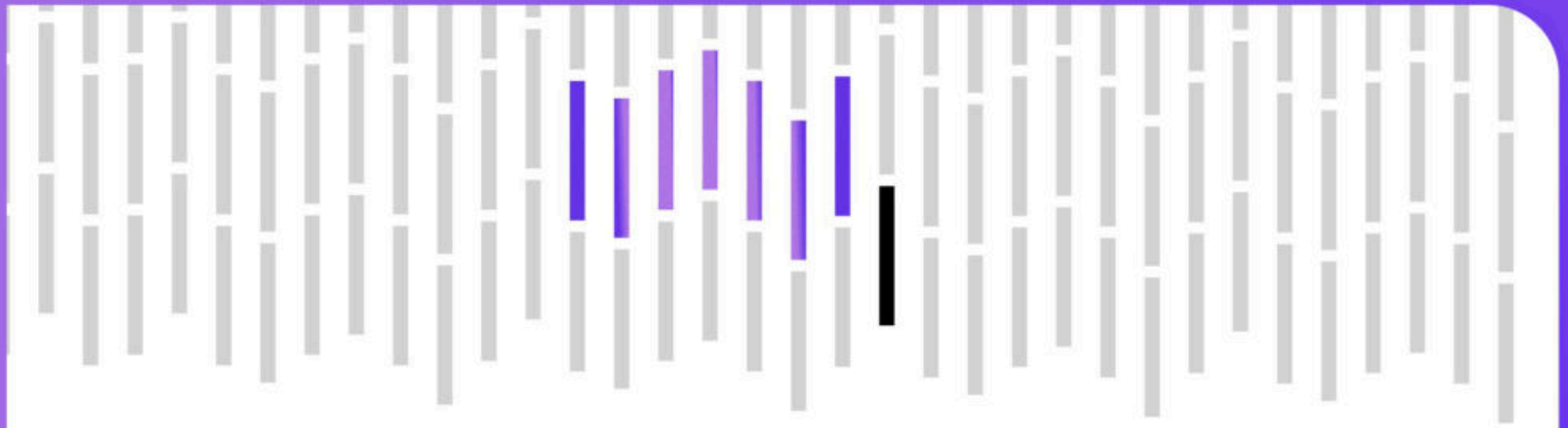
*UX Design is a **process** of creating experience which are effective, efficient, easy and enjoyable.*



*"UX Design is a **process**"*

*"Design Thinking is that **process**"*

Note: Design Thinking is not the only one we can use, there are multiple different frameworks available such as Double Diamond.



Section 3:

Design Thinking

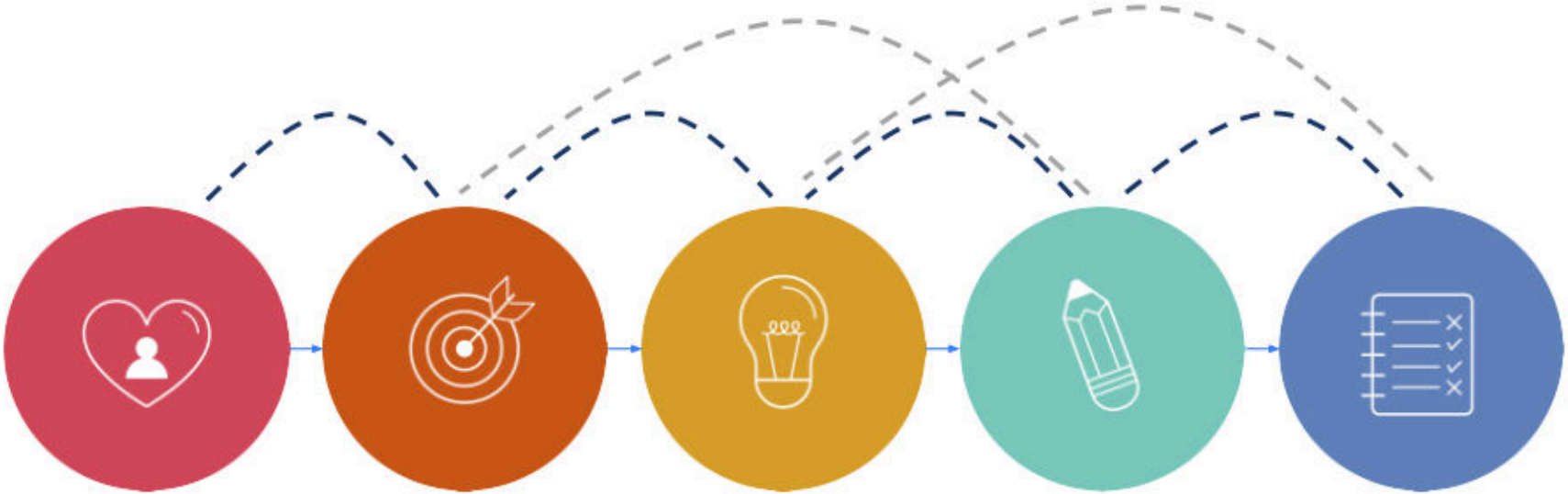
Design Thinking

Design Thinking is a human-centric problem-solving framework.

It emphasises on understanding user's needs, wants, goals and motivation while creating the solutions.

Design thinking can be used to solve problems as big as climate change and as small as what color to use for the buttons in your UI.

Design Thinking



Stage 1
Empathize

Stage 2
Define

Stage 3
Ideate

Stage 4
Prototype

Stage 5
Testing

It's is a problem-solving framework, not just a tool for a designer.

Design Thinking LIVE

For this Live session here is the problem statement

Over the past 3 weeks, user signups have declined by 25%, resulting in reduced new user acquisition and impacting growth targets. The drop appears to be concentrated in the signup flow, but the root cause is unclear.

Design Thinking

Understand your users — their needs, pain points, and behavior.

Design Thinking

Clearly define the core problem you are trying to solve.

Design Thinking

Generate multiple ideas and possible solutions to the problem.

Design Thinking

Create simple versions of your solution to explore how it works.

Design Thinking

Validate your solution with users and learn what works or fails.

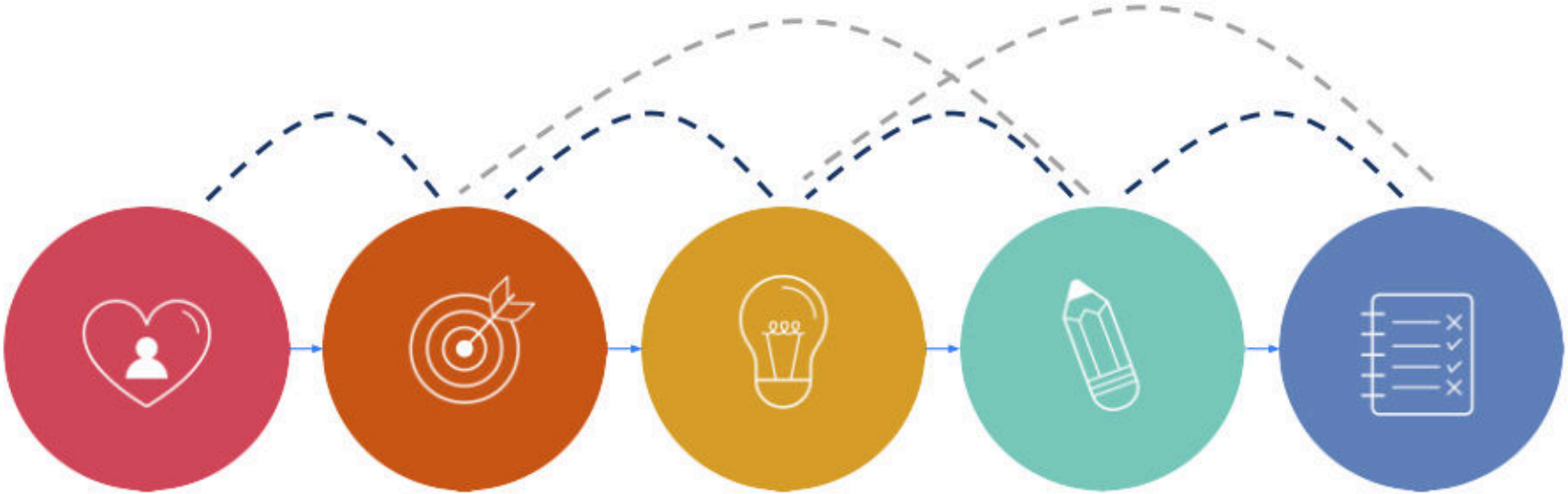
Usability Testing

Usability Testing is a method of validating the usability of the product.

Usability Testing are measure in following terms;

1. **Success rate:** Whether users were able complete a task
1. **Time:** How long it takes for users to complete a task
1. **Error rate:** How many errors users made
1. **Satisfaction:** How satisfied users were

Design Thinking



Stage 1
Empathize

Stage 2
Define

Stage 3
Ideate

Stage 4
Prototype

Stage 5
Testing

The U.U.D Framework

Every exceptional product/feature/functionality must answer three fundamental questions

Is it useful?

Does it solve a real user problem, address genuine needs, and provide clear functional value?

Is it usable?

Can users complete tasks efficiently with intuitive navigation, minimal cognitive load, and consistent patterns?

Is it delightful?

Does it create positive emotional connections, surprise users meaningfully, and build brand loyalty?

10 Usability Heuristics by NN Group (Jakob



Visibility of System Status

1



Match Between System & Real World

2



User Control And Freedom

3



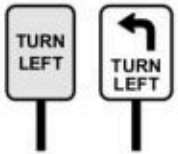
Consistency And Standards

4



Error Prevention

5



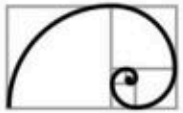
Recognition Rather Than Recall

6



Flexibility And Efficiency of Use

7



Aesthetic And Minimalistic Design

8



Help Users With Errors

9



Help And Documentation

10

10 Usability Heuristics

Nielsen Norman Group

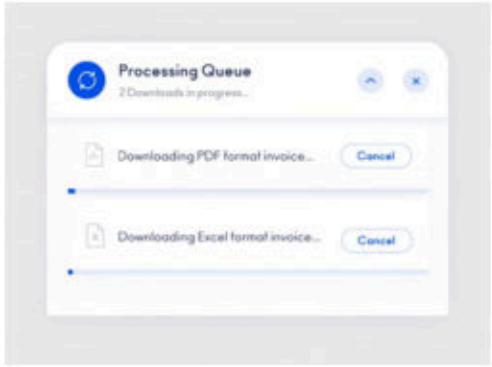
Jakob's Ten Usability Heuristics

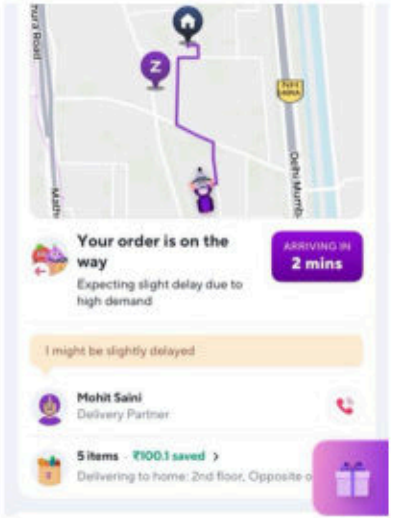
1 Visibility *of* System Status

Designs should *keep users informed* about what is going on, through appropriate, timely feedback.



Interactive mall maps have to show people where they currently are, to help them understand where to go next.





10 Usability Heuristics

1 Visibility *of* System Status

Designs should *keep users informed* about what is going on, through appropriate, timely feedback.



Interactive mall maps have to show people where they currently are, to help them understand where to go next.



10 Usability Heuristics

2 Match between System and the Real World

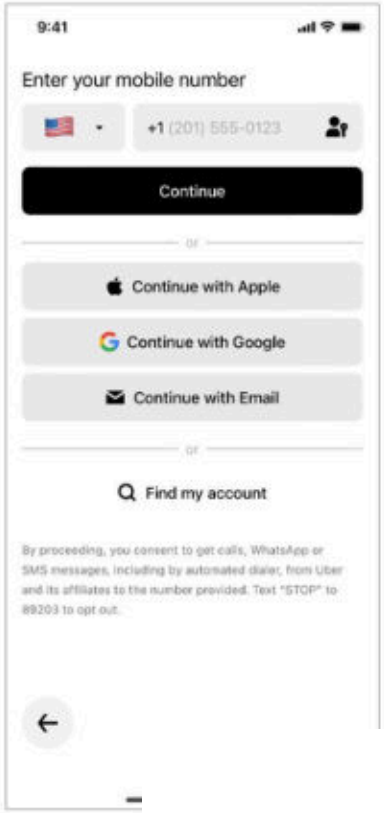
The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts *familiar to the user*, rather than internal jargon.



Users can quickly understand which stovetop control maps to each heating element.







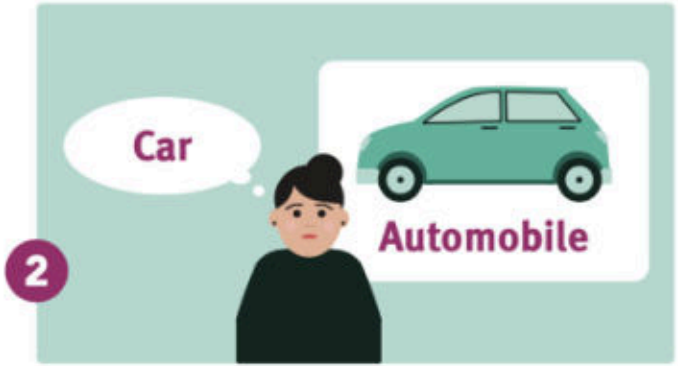
10 Usability Heuristics

2 Match between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts *familiar to the user*, rather than internal jargon.



Users can quickly understand which stovetop control maps to each heating element.





10 Usability Heuristics

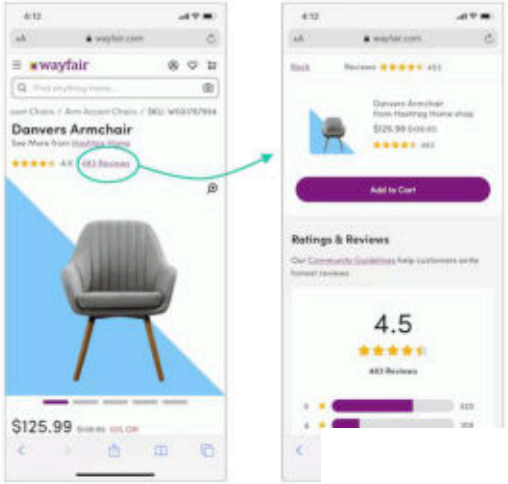


3 User Control *and* Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They *need a clearly marked "emergency exit"* to leave the unwanted action.



Just like physical spaces, digital spaces need quick "emergency" exits too.



10 Usability Heuristics

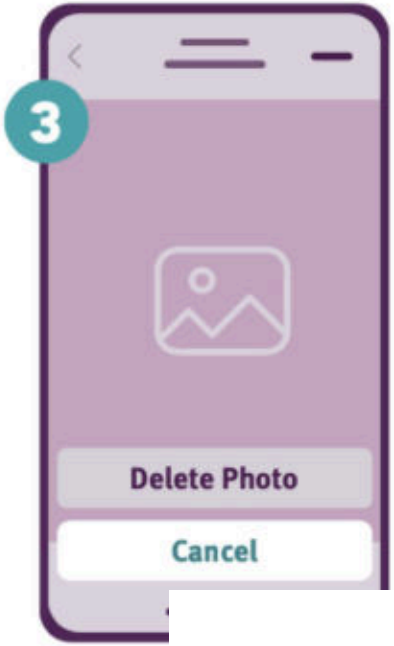
3 User Control *and* Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They *need a clearly marked "emergency exit"* to leave the unwanted action.



Just like physical spaces, digital spaces need quick "emergency" exits too.





10 Usability Heuristics

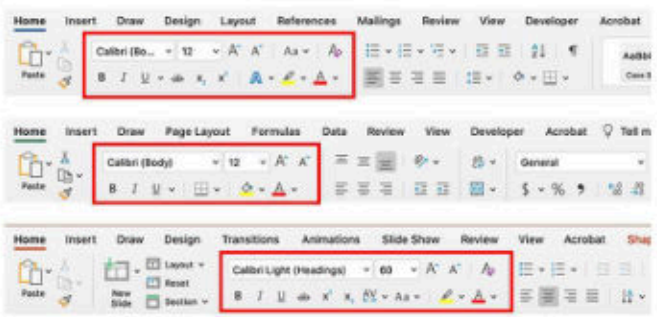
4 Consistency *and* Standards

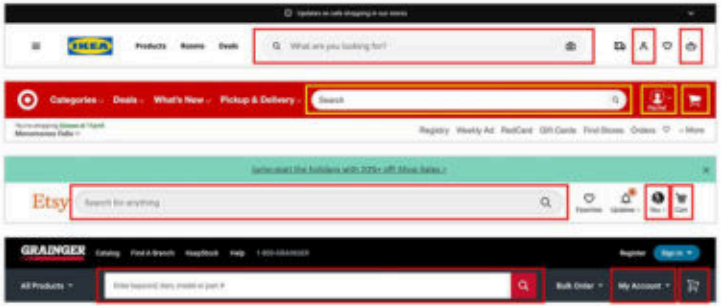
Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing.

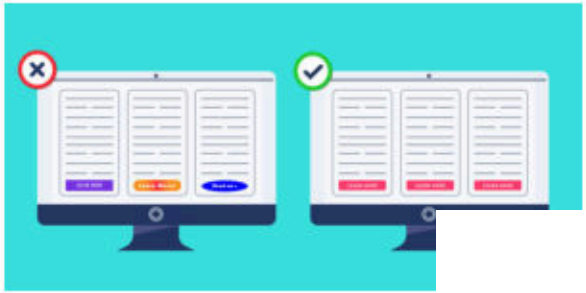
Follow platform conventions.



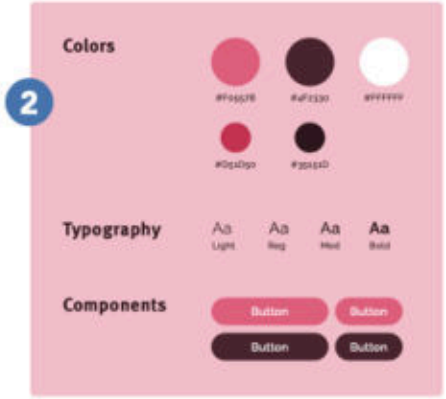
Check-in counters are usually located at the front of hotels, which meets expectations.







10 Usability Heuristics



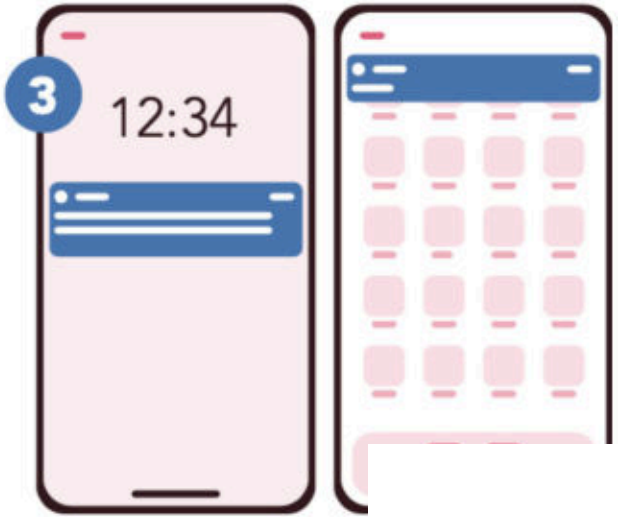
4 Consistency *and* Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing.

Follow platform conventions.



Check-in counters are usually located at the front of hotels, which meets expectations.



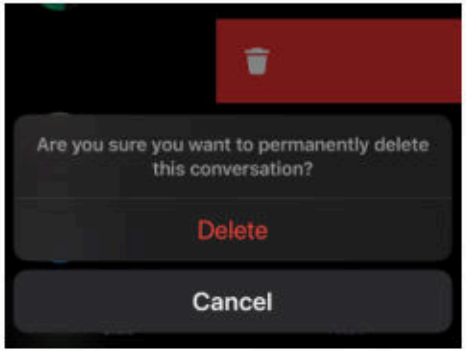
10 Usability Heuristics

5 Error Prevention

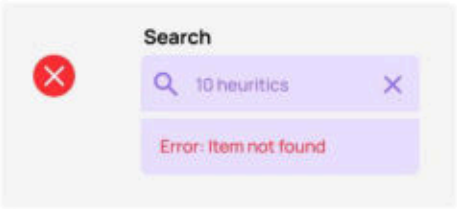
Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully *prevent problems* from occurring in the first place.

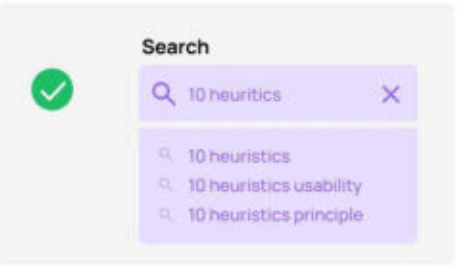


Guard rails on curvy mountain roads prevent drivers from falling off cliffs.







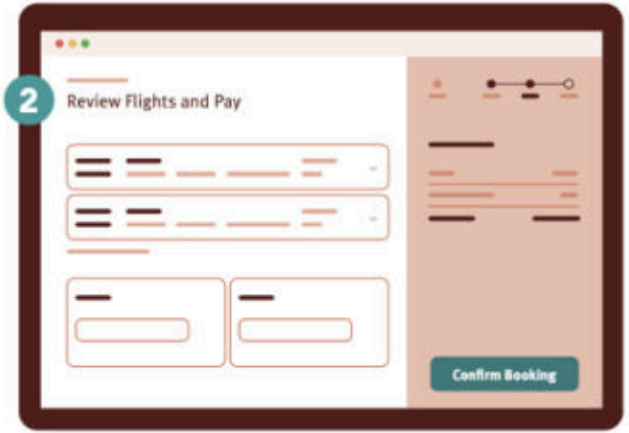


10 Usability Heuristics

5 Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully *prevent problems* from occurring in the first place.

Guard rails on curvy mountain roads prevent drivers from falling off cliffs.





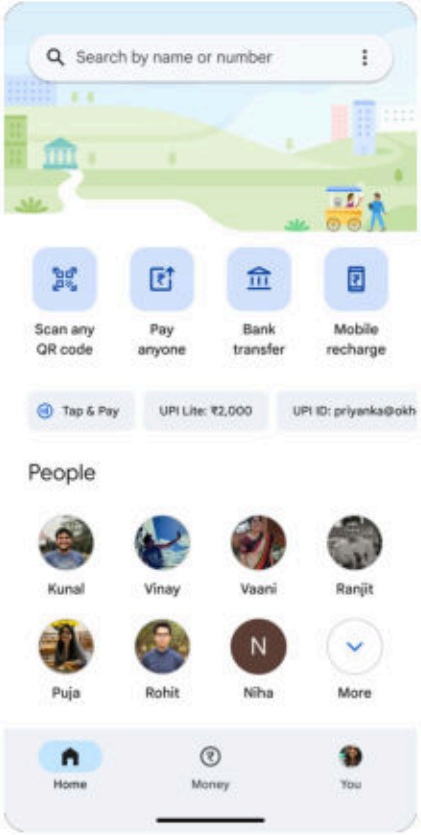
10 Usability Heuristics

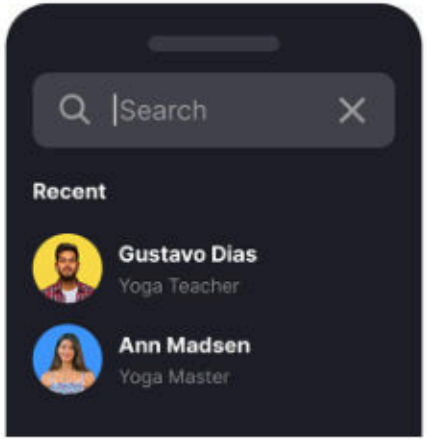
6 Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load **by making elements, actions, and options visible. Avoid making users remember information.**



People are likely to correctly answer “Is Lisbon the capital of Portugal?”.





10 Usability Heuristics

6 Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load **by making elements, actions, and options visible. Avoid making users remember information.**



People are likely to correctly answer “Is Lisbon the capital of Portugal?”.





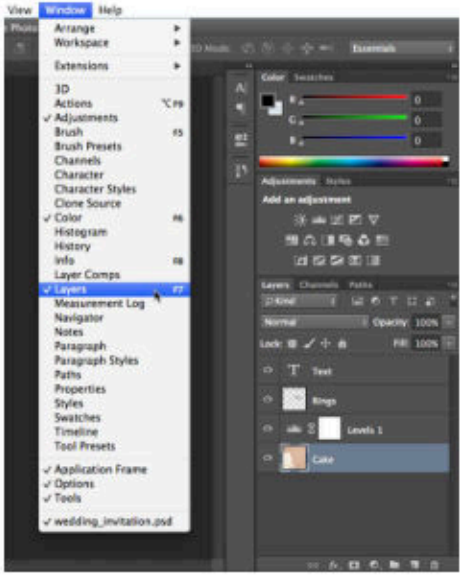
10 Usability Heuristics

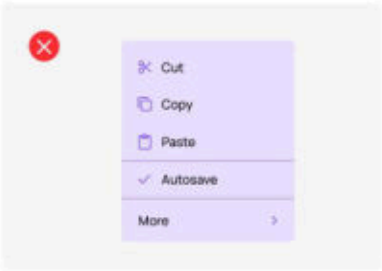
7 Flexibility *and* Efficiency of Use

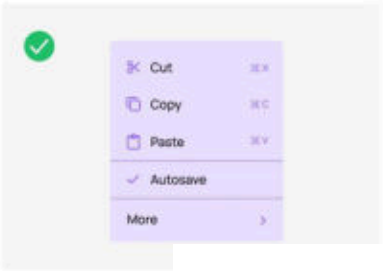
Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may *speed up the interaction* for the expert user.



Regular routes are listed on maps, but locals with more knowledge of the area can take shortcuts.







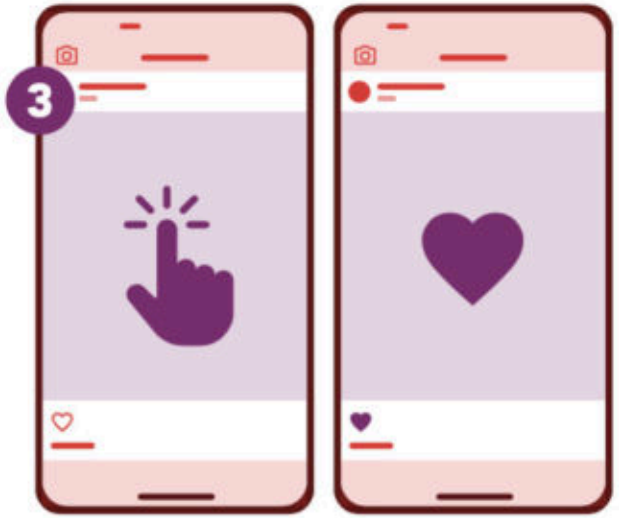
10 Usability Heuristics

7 Flexibility *and* Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may *speed up the interaction* for the expert user.



Regular routes are listed on maps, but locals with more knowledge of the area can take shortcuts.



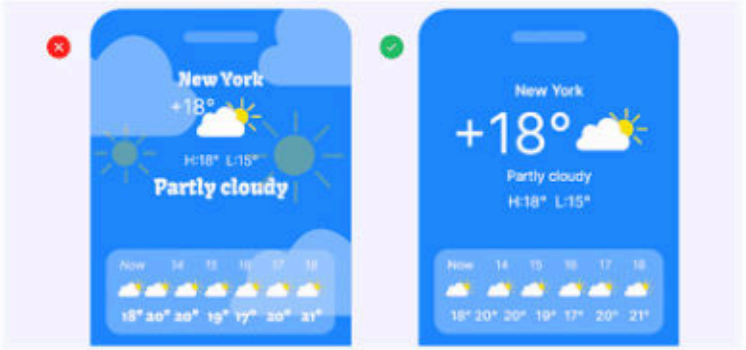
10 Usability Heuristics

8 Aesthetic *and* Minimalist Design

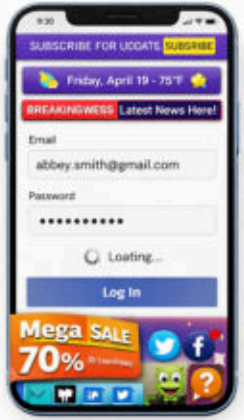
Interfaces should not contain information which is irrelevant. Every extra unit of information in an interface *competes* with the relevant units of information.



A minimalist three-legged stool is still a place to sit.



Form follows Functions





10 Usability Heuristics

8 Aesthetic *and* Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information which is irrelevant. Every extra unit of information in an interface *competes* with the relevant units of information.



A minimalist three-legged stool is still a place to sit.





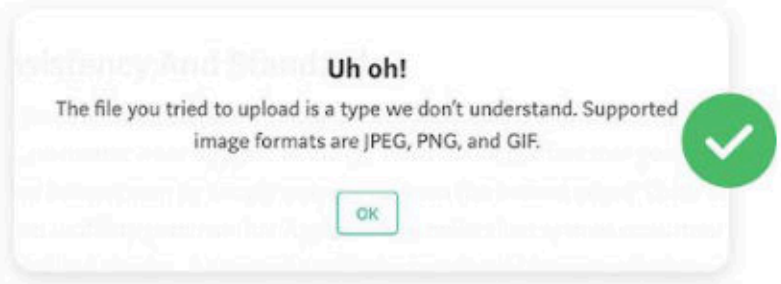
10 Usability Heuristics

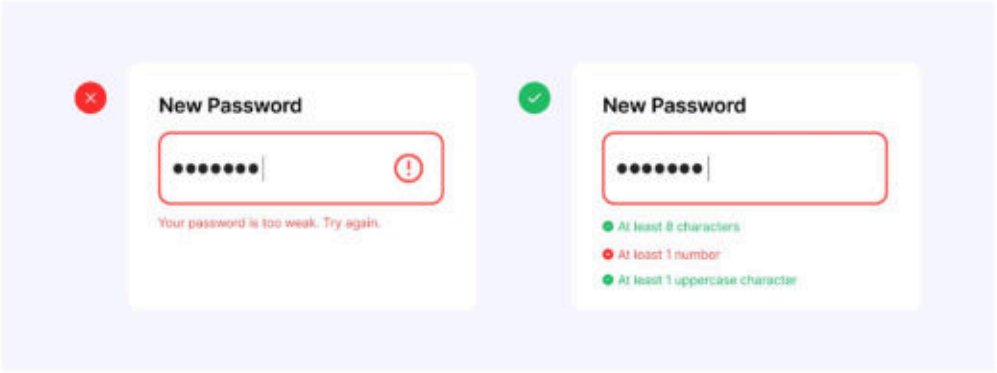
9 Recognize, Diagnose, *and* Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.



Wrong-way signs on the road remind drivers that they are heading in the wrong direction.





10 Usability Heuristics

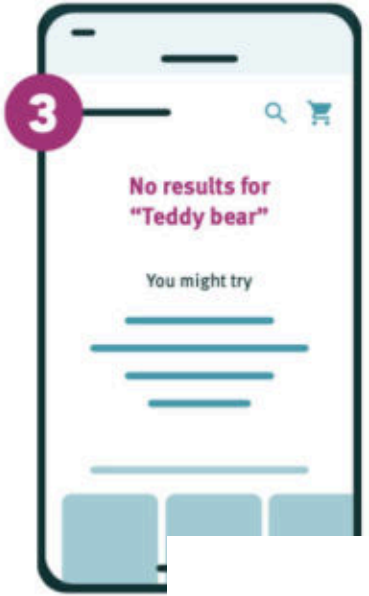
9 Recognize, Diagnose, *and* Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.



Wrong-way signs on the road remind drivers that they are heading in the wrong direction.





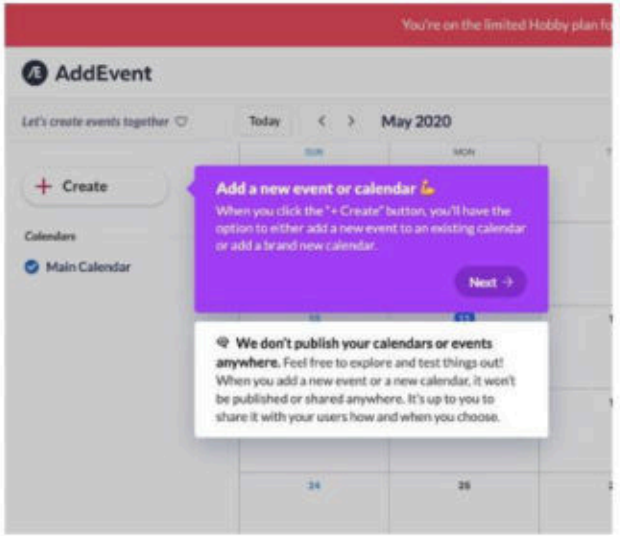
10 Usability Heuristics

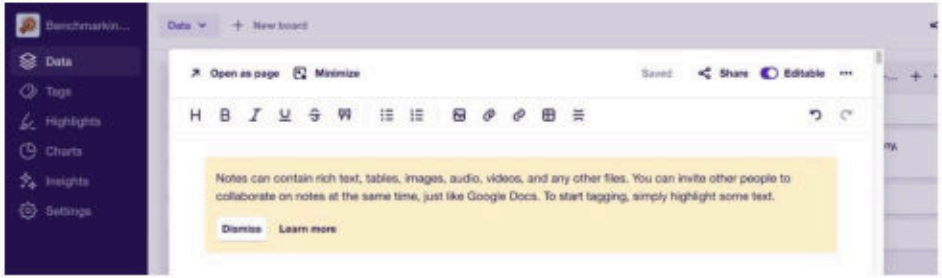
10 Help *and* Documentation

It's best if the design *doesn't need* any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users complete their tasks.



Information kiosks at airports are easily recognizable and solve customers' problems in context and immediately.





10 Usability Heuristics

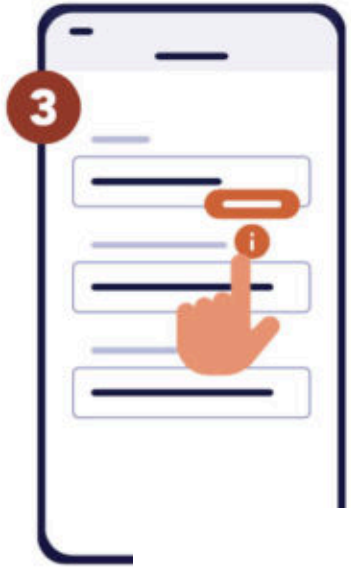
10 Help *and* Documentation

It's best if the design *doesn't need* any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users complete their tasks.



Information kiosks at airports are easily recognizable and solve customers' problems in context and immediately.

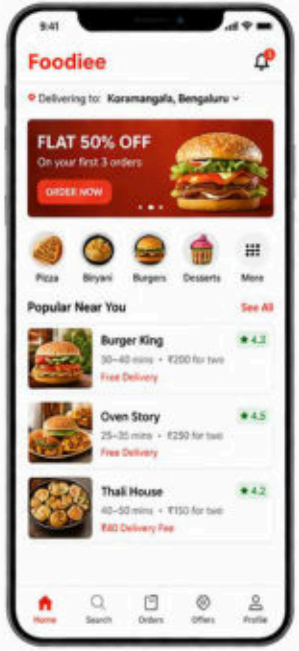




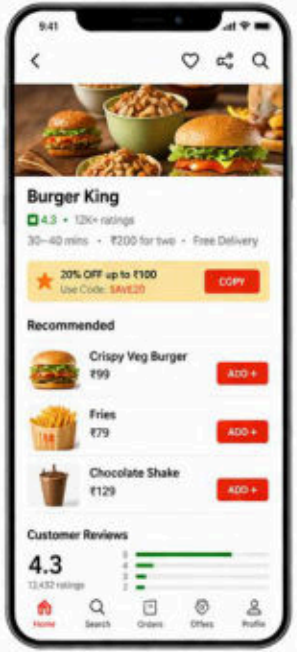
FOODIEE – FOOD DELIVERY APP JOURNEY

Your Task: Review the following screens for **the complete food ordering journey.** Identify **usability** issues according to the **10 Heuristics for User Interface Design.**

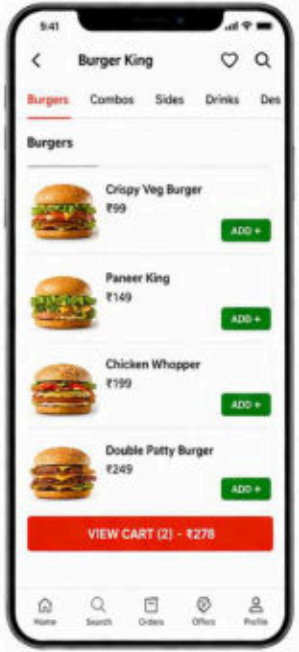
1. HOME



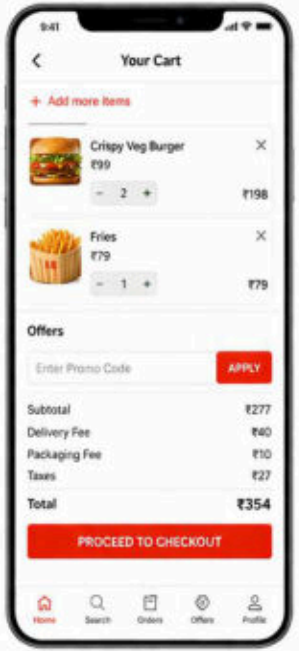
2. RESTAURANT



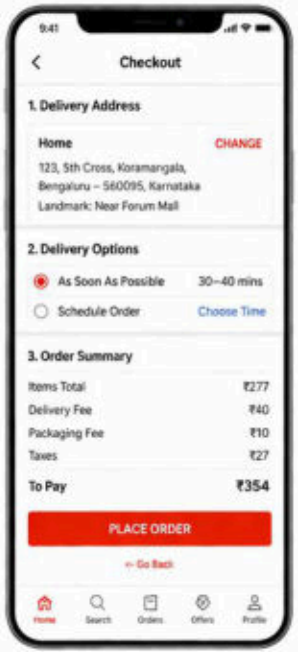
3. MENU



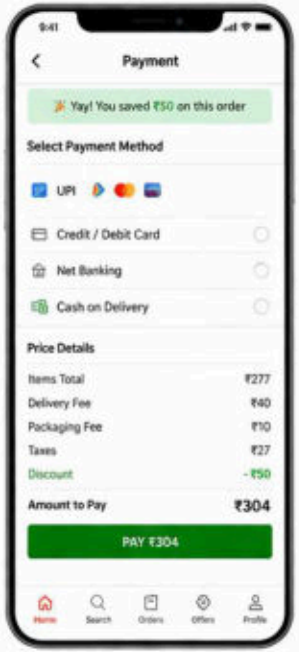
4. CART



5. CHECKOUT



6. PAYMENT



Day 2 – Understanding UX

1. Different Components of UX Design
2. Different Roles in UX Team
3. Design System
4. UX Laws
5. Figma Demo with Design System (Design Kit)
6. Breakout Room Activity
7. Tips for effective Collaboration with UX Team
8. Q&A and Conclusion

User Research



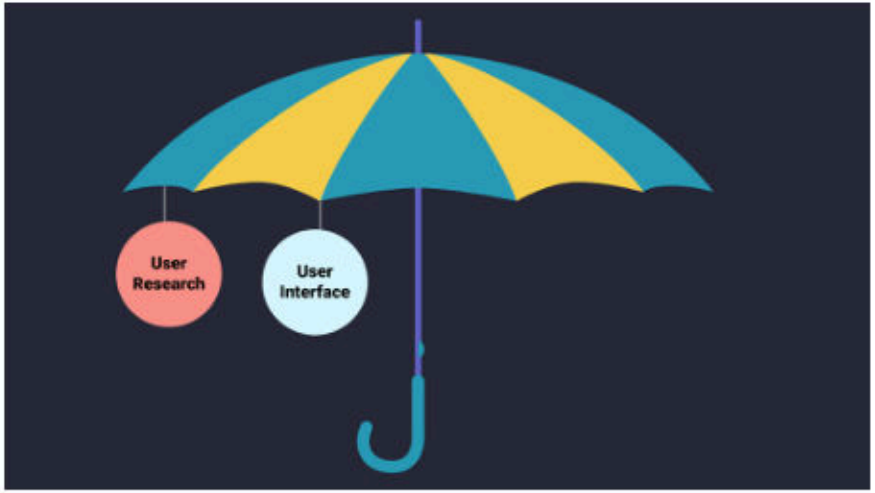
User Research is the process of understanding user's needs, goals, motivations and behaviors.

- User Research is the first thing the designer does before jumping into any design tool (Figma)
- User Research help designer build empathy towards the users
- User Research help in finding the unsaid needs of the users

Some of the most common user research methods are

- User Interview
- Surveys
- Contextual Enquires

User Interface

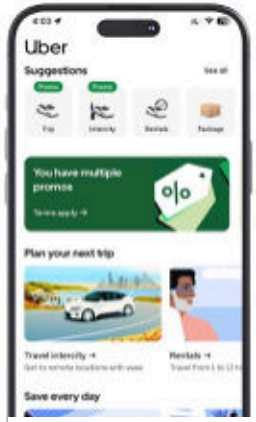


User Interface is a process of creating the interface for the interaction between the users and products.

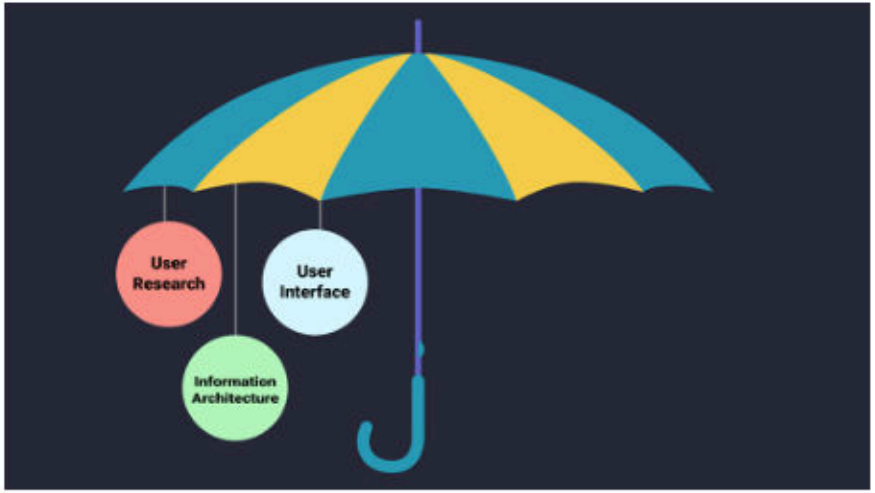
- User Interface Designer or UI Designer primarily focuses on the look and feel of the products.
- UI Designers are responsible for everything which is visible in the screen

Some of the primary elements UI Designer takes care of are

- Colors
- Typography
- Layout
- Shapes
- Icons, Images, Illustrations
- Animation
- Copy

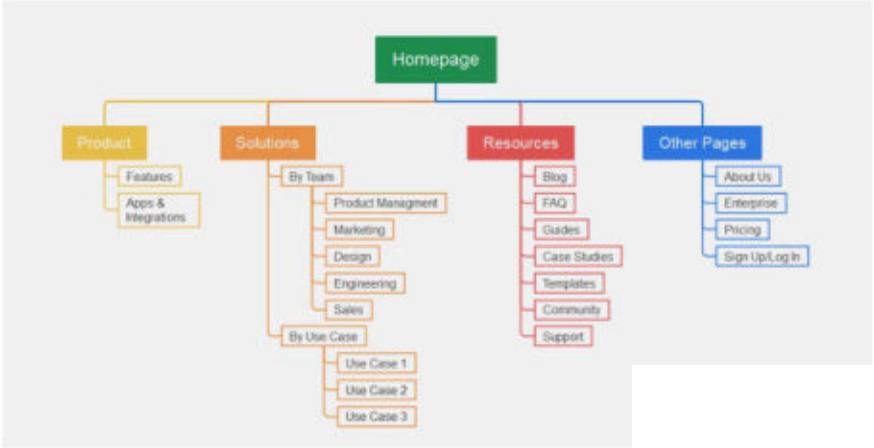


Information Architecture



Information Architecture is a process of categorizing and labeling content or features in a logical order, so that anyone can understand how the products works

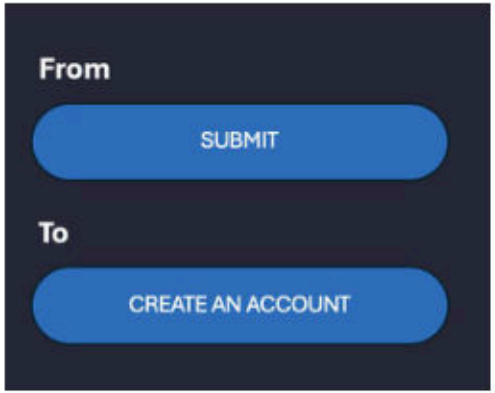
The outcome of the IA is a visual representation of product hierarchy.



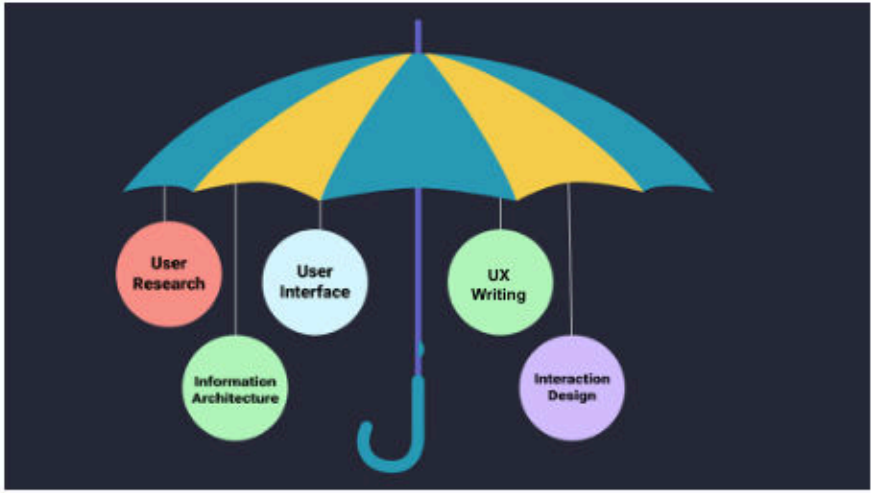
UX Writing

UX Writing or microcopy is a branch of Copywriting where the primary focus is on writing content for digital products.

UX Writer make sure to use word and phrases which is best suitable for the target users.

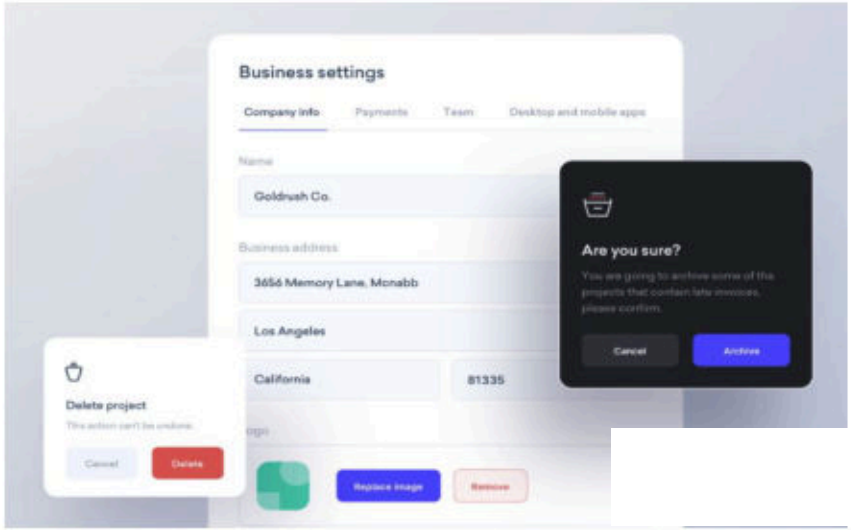


Interaction Design



Interaction Design (IxD) is a process of defining the interaction between the users and the products.

Interaction Designers makes sure that the interaction between the products and the user is simple and easy to understand.

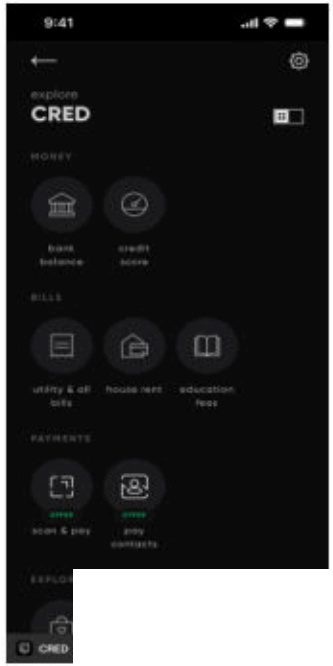


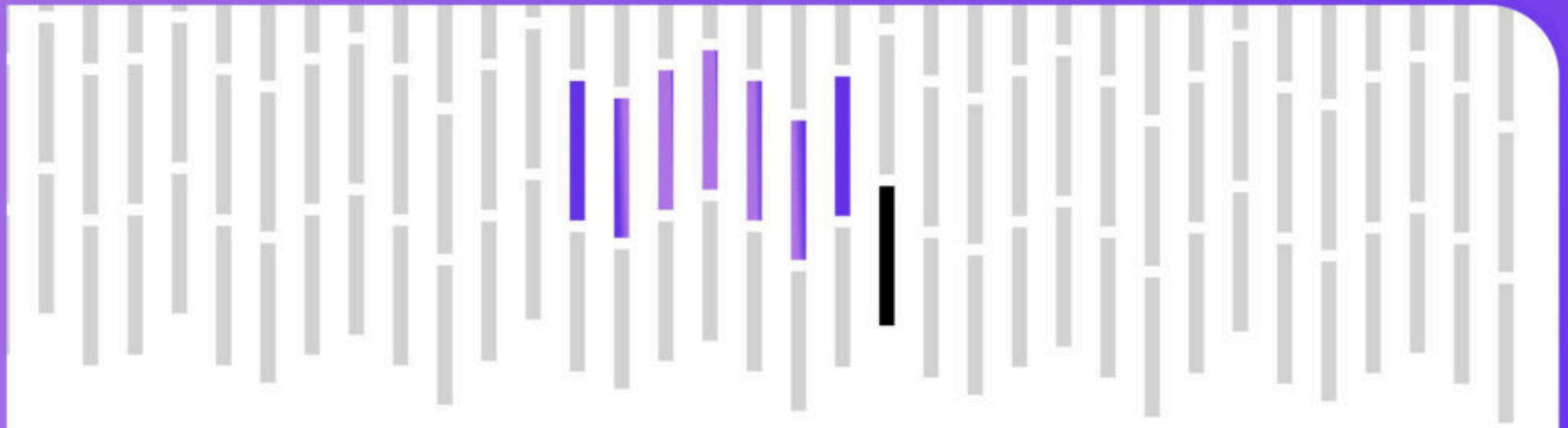
Accessibility



Accessibility is the process of designing the product in such a manner that anyone can use the product, even the users with disabilities.

Bad Examples	Good Examples
Blue on black is bad	Yellow on black is good
Green on orange is bad	Black on orange is good
Red on green is bad	Black on green is good
Grey on purple is bad	White on purple is good



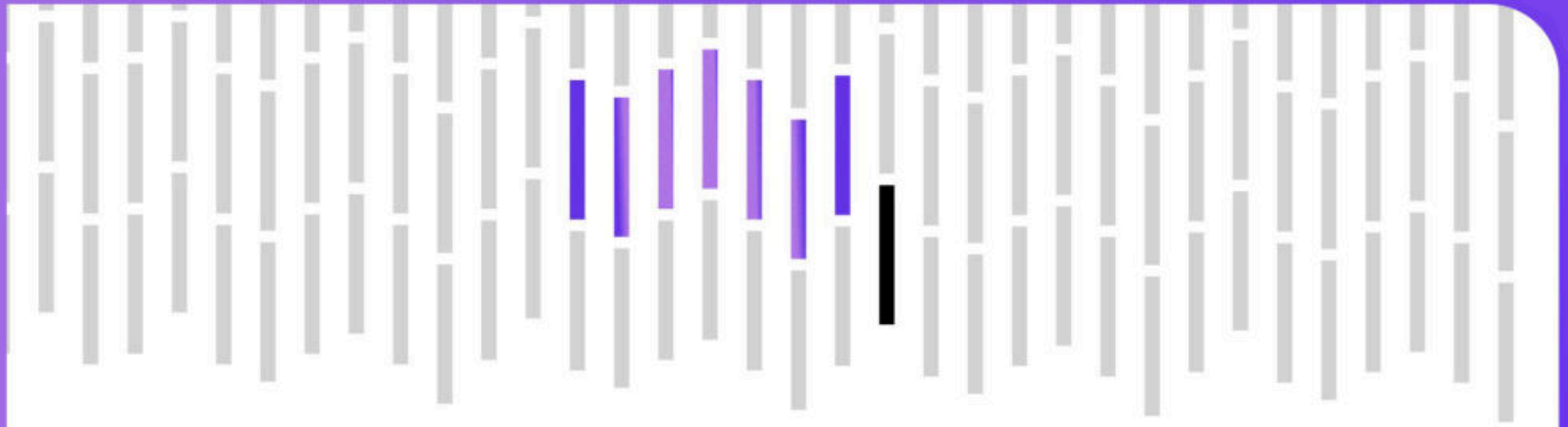


Section 5:

Roles in UX Team

Roles in UX Team

- UX Designer
- UX Researcher
- UI Designer (Visual Designer)
- Information Architecture
- Interaction Designer
- UX Writer
- Usability Expert
- Accessibility Expert

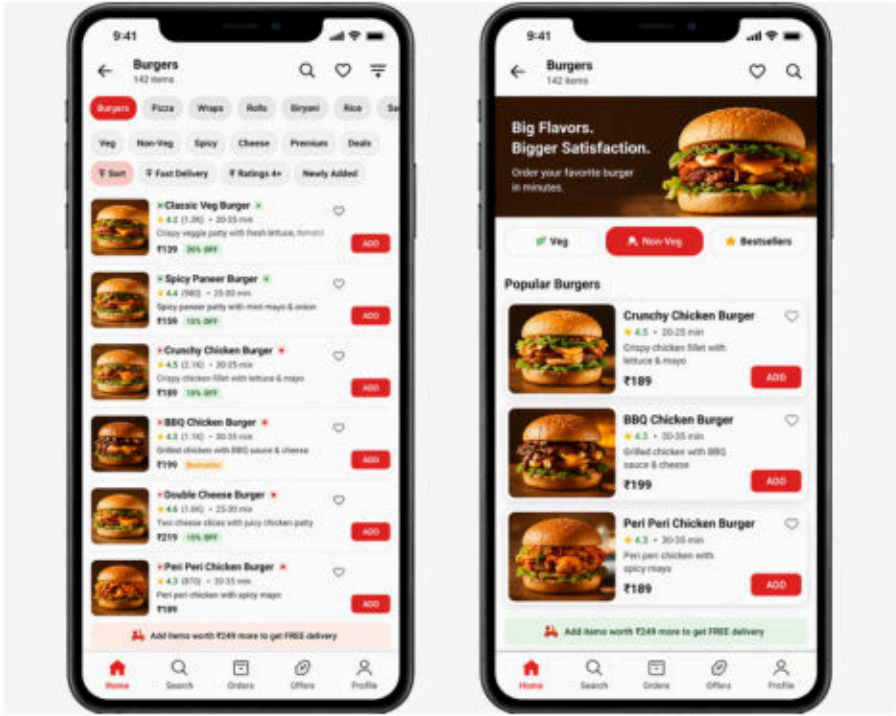


15 most commonly used UX Laws

UX Laws 1: Hick’s Law

Hick's Law is a principle in user experience design that states that the time it takes for a person to make a decision increases with the number of options they have to choose from. In other words, the more options you give someone, the longer it will take for them to make a decision.

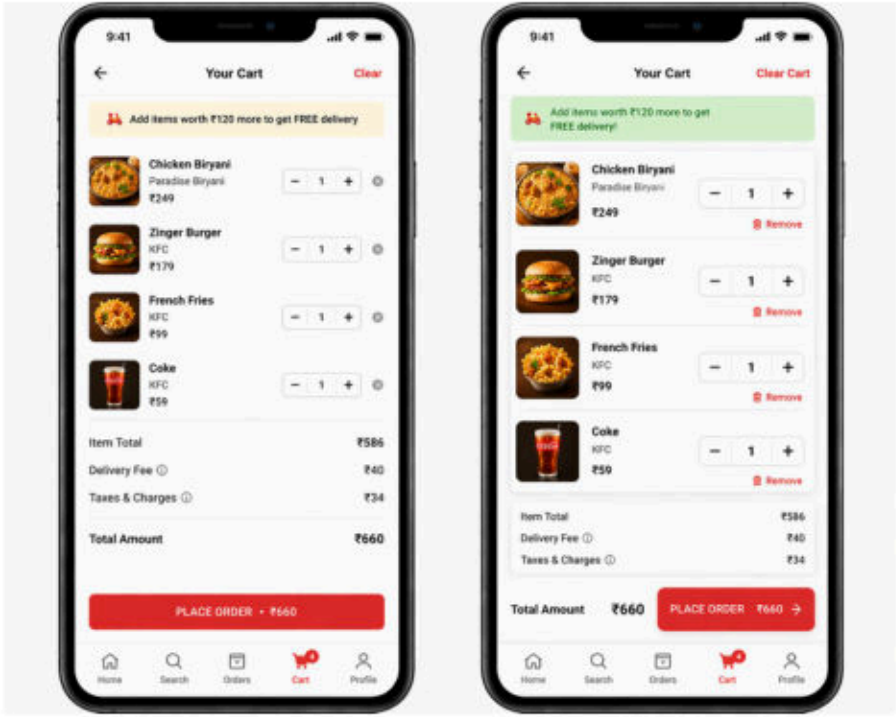
A practical example of Hick's Law in action is the Google homepage



UX Laws 2: Fitt’s Law

Fitt's Law is a principle in user experience design that states that the time it takes to move to a target depends on the distance to the target and the size of the target. In other words, the larger and closer a target is, the easier it is to hit.

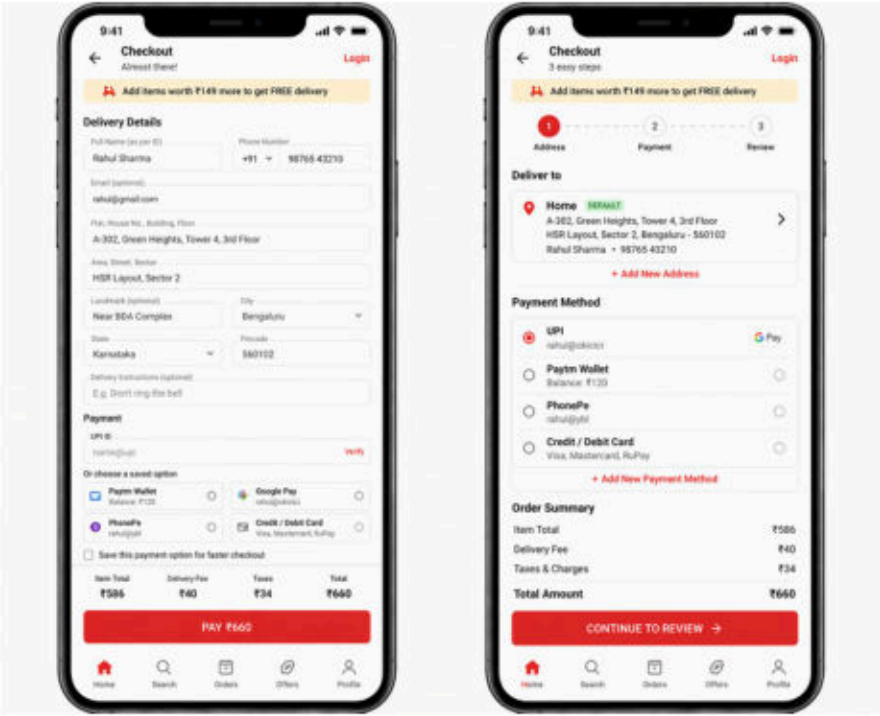
A practical example of Fitt's Law in action is the size and placement of navigation links on a website.



UX Laws 3: Miller’s Law

Miller's Law is a principle in cognitive psychology that states that the average person can only hold 7 (plus or minus 2) items in their working memory at any given time. In other words, our capacity for processing information is limited and we can only handle a certain amount of information at once.

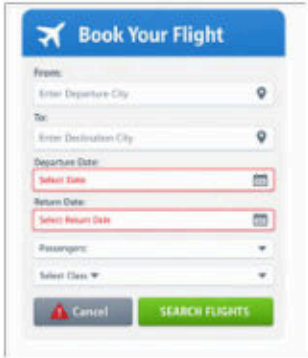
A practical example of Miller's Law in action is in the design of forms or surveys. By limiting the number of questions or fields on a form, you can make it easier for users to complete the form and reduce the likelihood of errors or user drop-off.

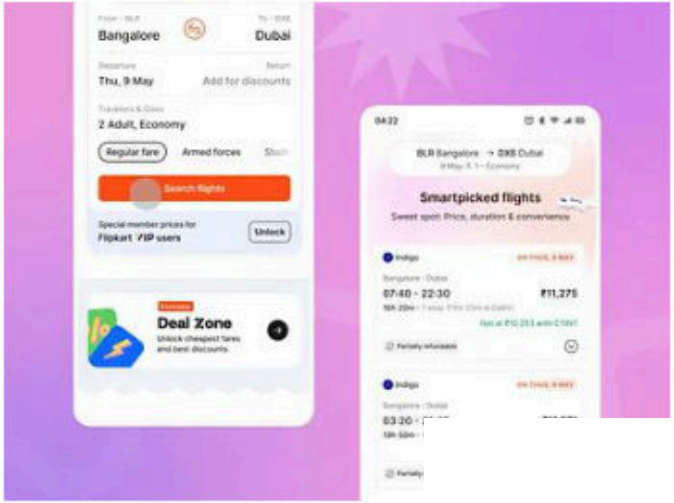


UX Laws 4: The Aesthetic–Usability Effect

The Aesthetic-Usability Effect is a principle in user experience design that states that users perceive aesthetically pleasing designs as more usable and efficient, even if they are not necessarily easier to use. In other words, users are more likely to view an attractive design as being more user-friendly and enjoyable to use, even if it doesn't necessarily make the user's tasks faster or more efficient.

A practical example of the Aesthetic-Usability Effect in action is the design of Apple products, which are often praised for their sleek and minimalist design.

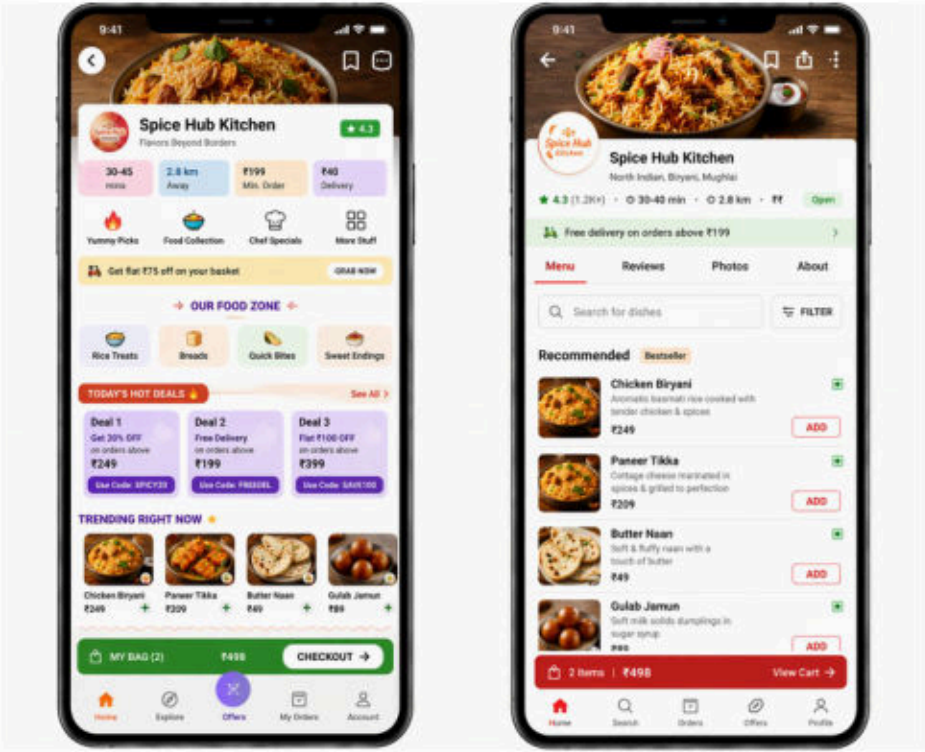




UX Laws 5: Jakob’s Law

Jakob's Law is a principle in user experience design that states that users expect a website or app to work the way other websites or apps work. In other words, users bring their past experiences with similar products or interfaces to their current experience, and they expect the same patterns and conventions to apply.

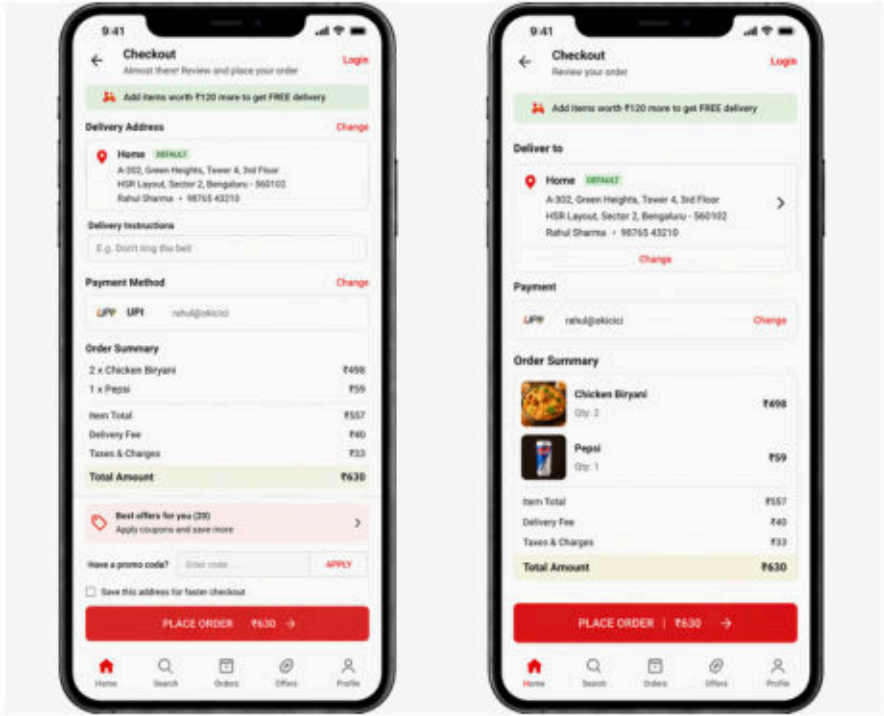
A practical example of Jakob's Law in action is the use of standardized icons for common actions or features.



UX Laws 6: Parkinson’s Law

While Parkinson's Law is more commonly associated with time management, it can also be applied to user experience design. In the context of UX, Parkinson's Law can be interpreted as the idea that the complexity of a design will often expand to fill the space available for it, potentially leading to over-designed or cluttered interfaces.

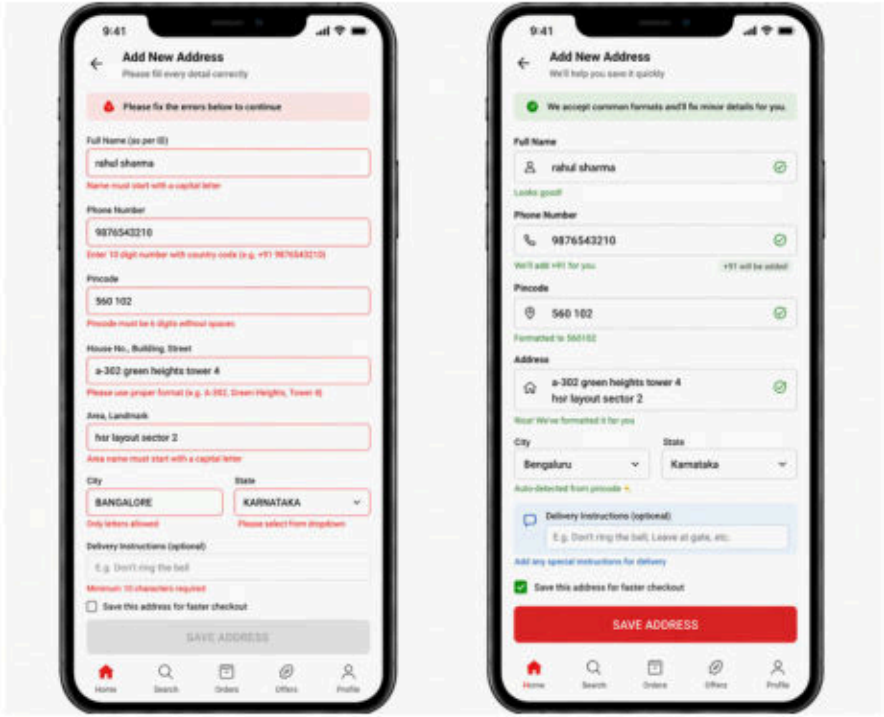
A practical example of Parkinson's Law in UX design is the use of minimalism and simplicity to create a more effective user experience.



UX Laws 7: Postel’s Law

Postel's Law, also known as the "Robustness Principle," is a principle in computer network design. This law can be applied to a variety of design scenarios, such as software design, API design, or web design. For example, a web application should be designed to be tolerant of different user agents, browsers, or input formats, so that it can handle unexpected input and still function correctly.

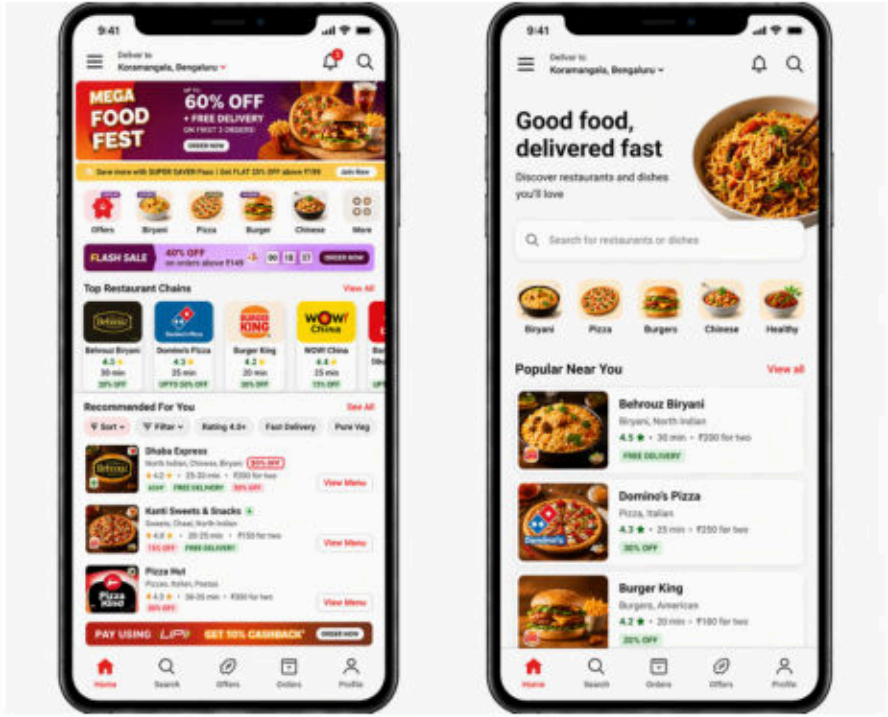
A practical example of Postel's Law in action is the use of error handling and input validation in software design.



UX Laws 8: Tesler’s Law

Tesler's Law, also known as The Law of Conservation of Complexity, is a principle in user experience design that states that the complexity of a system is fixed and can't be reduced, only shifted from one part of the system to another. In other words, reducing complexity in one part of a system will inevitably increase complexity in another part of the system.

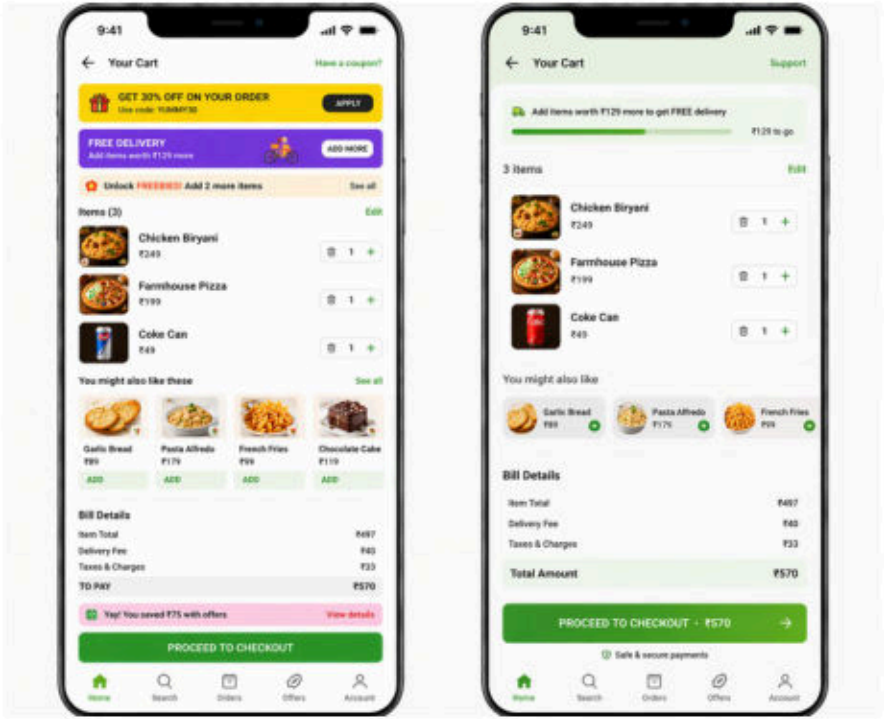
For example, simplifying the user interface of a software application might make it easier for users to complete tasks, but could increase the complexity of the underlying system architecture required to support that user interface.



UX Laws 9: Goal-Gradient Effect

The Goal-Gradient Effect is a phenomenon in psychology and user experience design that suggests that people are more motivated to complete a task as they get closer to the end goal. In other words, as people progress toward a goal, their motivation to continue and complete the task increases.

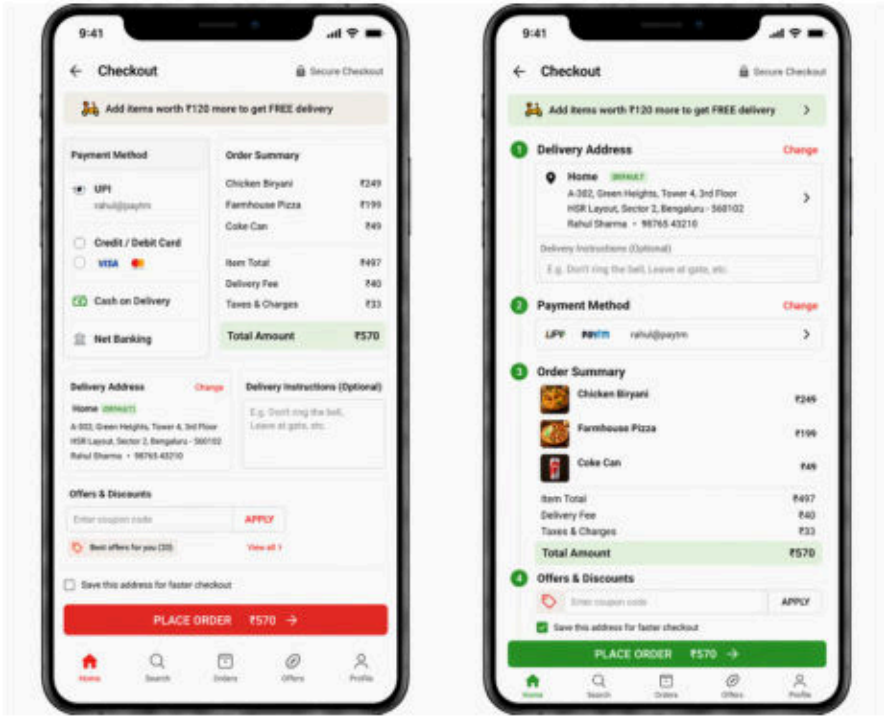
A practical example of the Goal-Gradient Effect in action is the use of progress bars in e-commerce sites.



UX Laws 10: Serial Position Effect

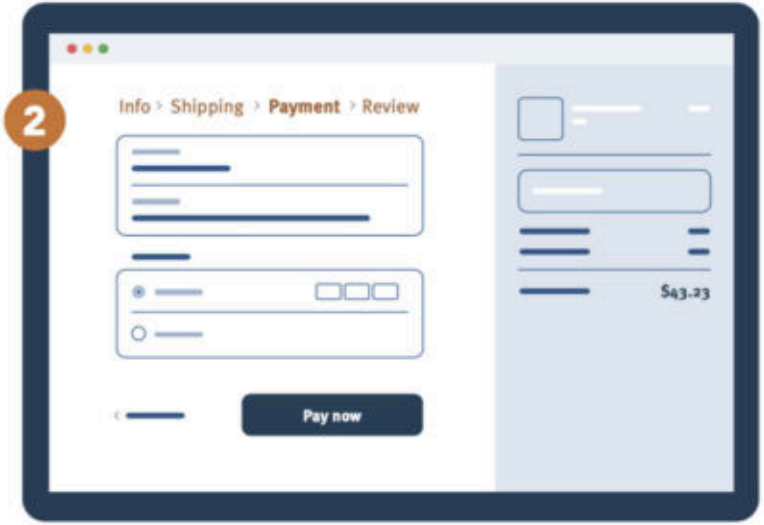
The Serial Position Effect is a cognitive phenomenon that suggests that people tend to remember the first and last items in a series more easily than the items in the middle. This effect is important in UX design because it emphasizes the importance of carefully structuring and ordering the content in an interface to optimize users' memory of the information presented.

A practical example of the Serial Position Effect in action in UX design is the design of a navigation menu.



UX Laws 11: Information Scent

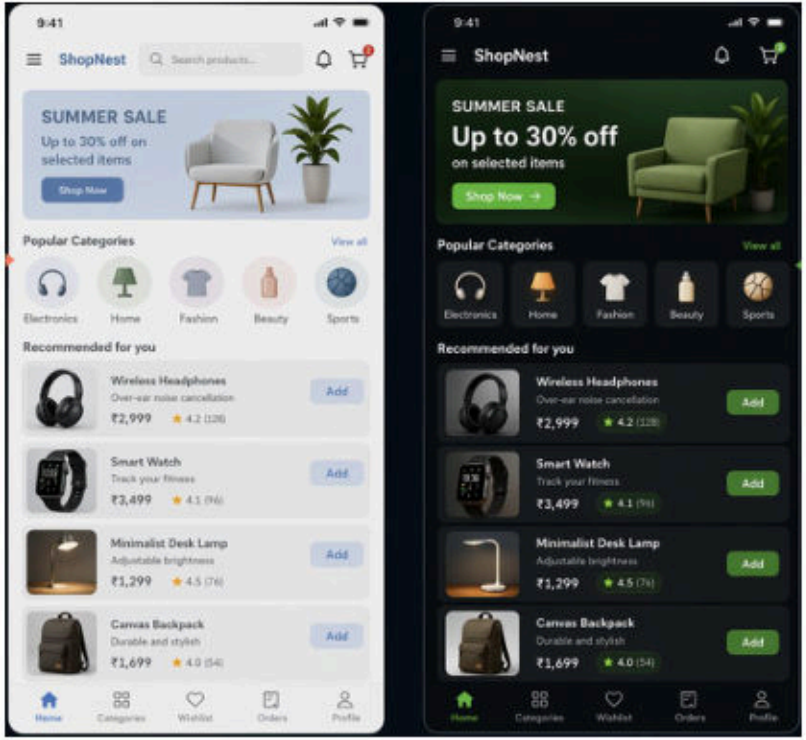
Information Scent is a principle in UX design that refers to the degree to which the information scent (i.e., the visual and textual cues) of a website or application matches the user's information needs. The goal of information scent is to help users quickly find the information they are looking for by providing visual and textual cues that lead them to relevant content.



UX Laws 12: Figure-Ground

The Figure-Ground principle is a basic principle of perception that suggests that people perceive objects or figures in a visual scene as being distinct from the background or "ground". This principle is important in UX design because it can help designers create interfaces that are easier to understand and navigate.

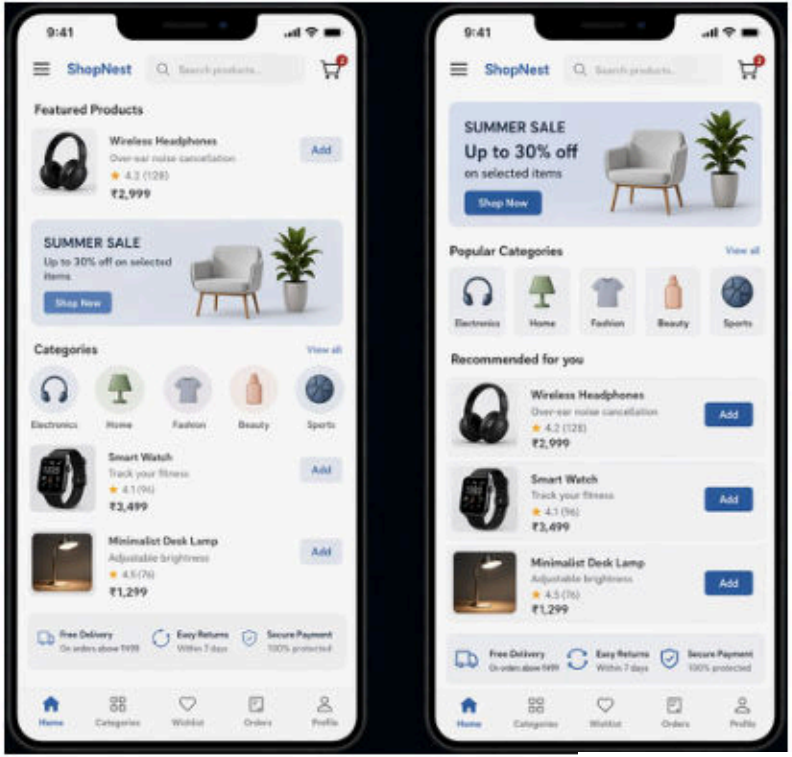
A practical example of the Figure-Ground principle in action in UX design is the use of contrasting colors or visual cues to make elements of an interface stand out from the background.



UX Laws 13: Law of Proximity

The Law of Proximity is a principle of perception that suggests that people tend to group together elements or objects that are physically close to each other. This principle is important in UX design because it can help designers create interfaces that are easier to understand and navigate.

A practical example of the Law of Proximity in action in UX design is the use of visual groupings to indicate related content or elements. For example, designers may group related links or buttons together within a specific area of a webpage or app screen, making it clear to users that these elements are related and belong together.



UX Laws 14: Von Restorff Effect (or Isolation Effect):

The Von Restorff Effect, also known as the Isolation Effect, is a phenomenon in psychology and user experience design that suggests that people are more likely to remember items or elements that stand out from their surroundings. In other words, when presented with a group of similar items, people are more likely to remember the one that is different or distinctive.

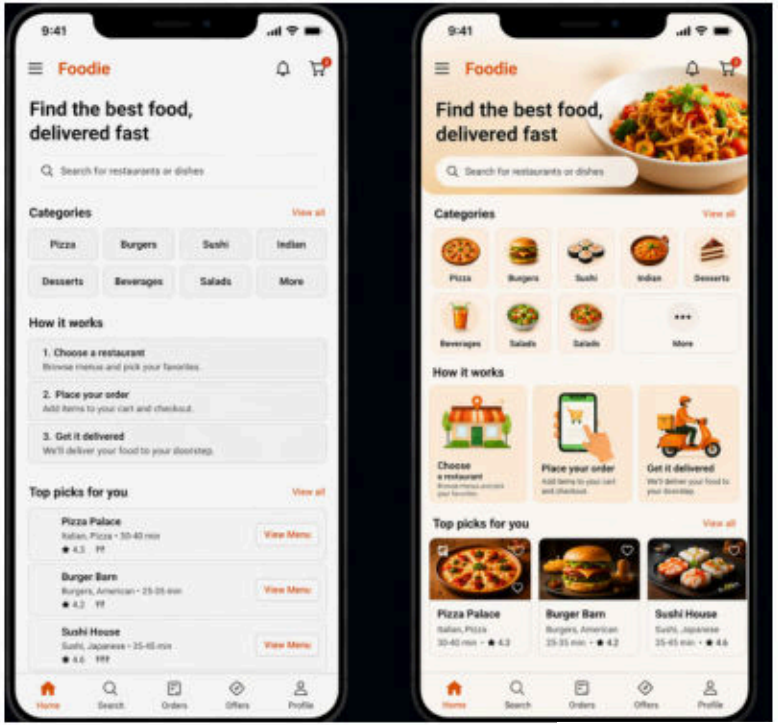
A practical example of the Von Restorff Effect in action in UX design is the use of bold or contrasting colors to draw attention to important elements or calls to action.

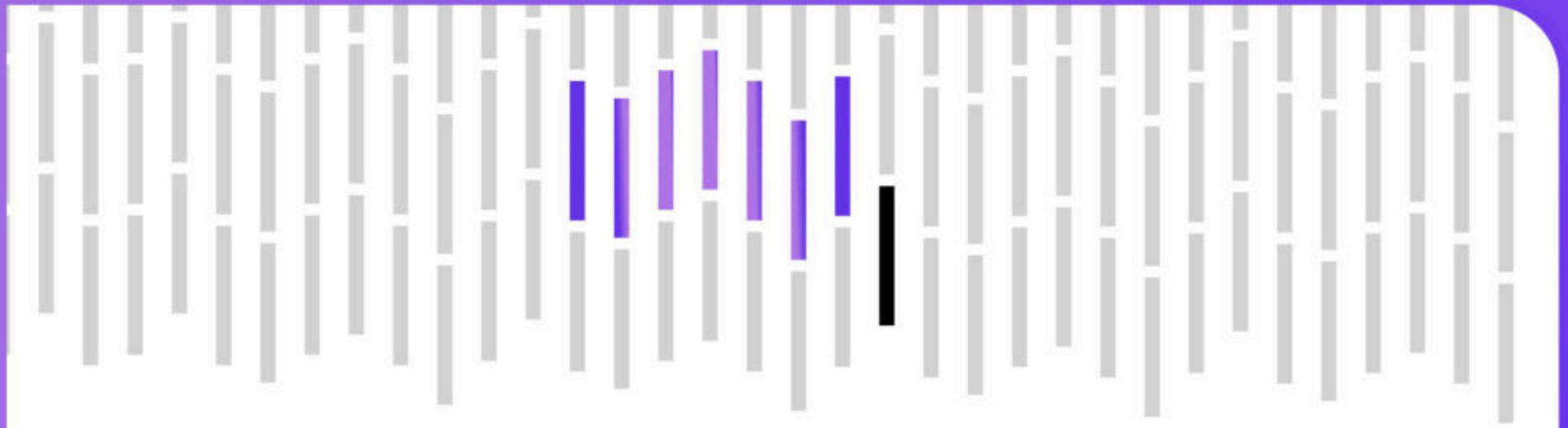


UX Laws 15. Picture Superiority Effect

The Picture Superiority Effect is a cognitive phenomenon that suggests that people tend to remember visual information, such as pictures or images, more easily and more accurately than verbal or written information, such as text or spoken words. In other words, people tend to retain information better when it is presented in a visual format, rather than a verbal or written format.

A practical example of the Picture Superiority Effect in action in UX design is the use of visual aids, such as icons or illustrations, to help users navigate an interface or understand complex information.



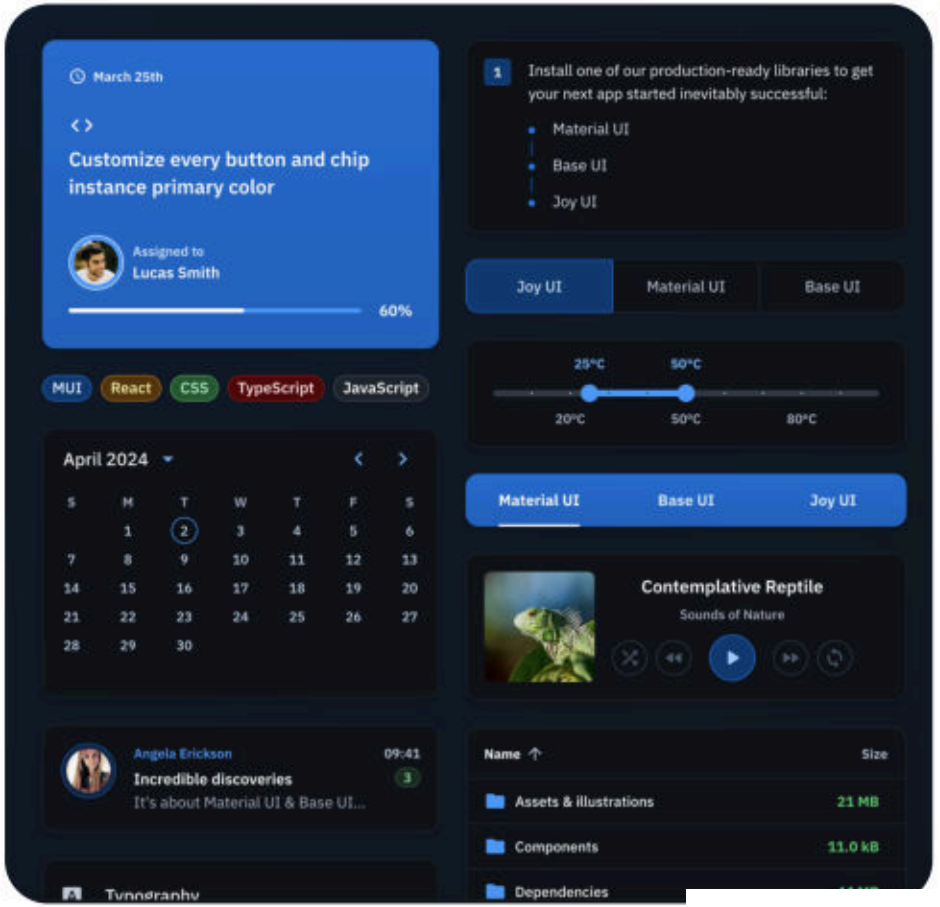


Section 6:

Design System

What is a Design System?

A design system is essentially a collection of **reusable components**, **guidelines**, and **resources** that helps teams create consistent and user-friendly digital products.



Example:

Vibe design system by monday.com

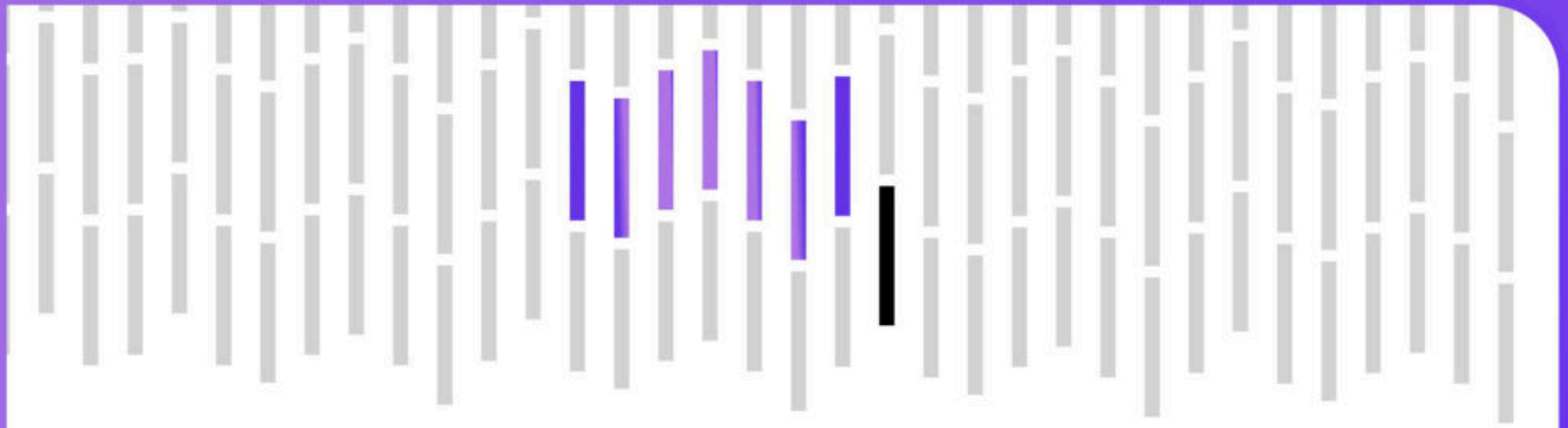
UI Kit ≠ Design System

UI Kit is one of the outcome of Design System

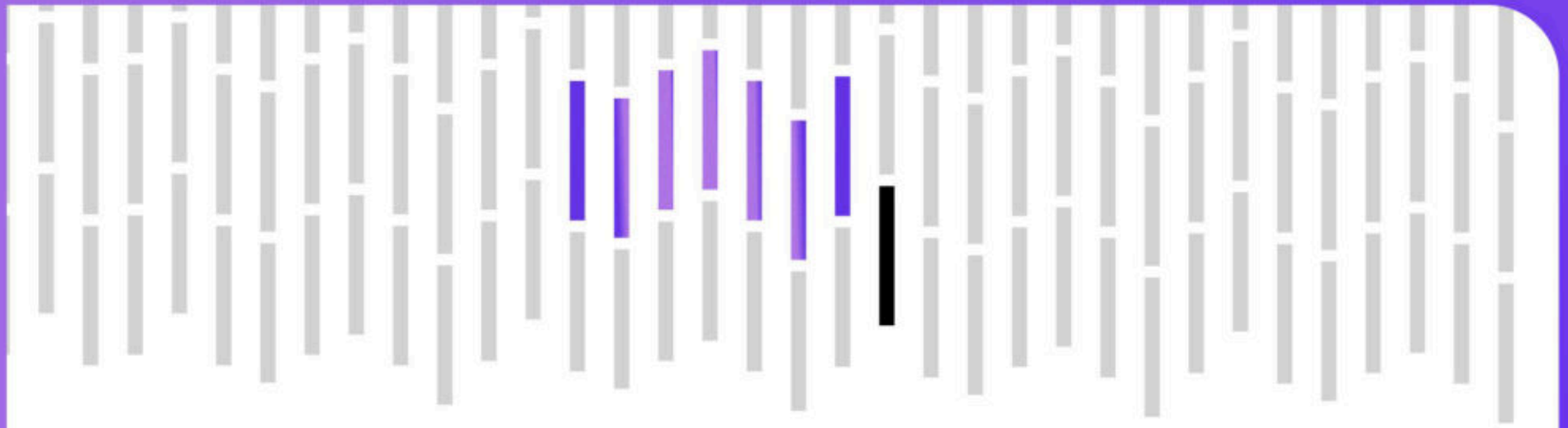


Example:

Google Material Design
Apple Human Interface Design



Figma Demo with Design System (Design Kit)



Tips for effective Collaboration with the UX Team

Collaborate with Designers as a Product Manager

1. **Speak a common language:** Familiarize yourself with basic design principles and terminology. This will help bridge the communication gap and facilitate better discussions.

1. **Involve designers early in the product development process:** Don't wait until the product roadmap is finalized to bring designers on board. Their insights can be valuable in shaping the product vision and features.

1. **Value the designer's expertise:** Recognize the designer's skills and knowledge as essential for creating successful products. Encourage their input and ideas throughout the process.

1. **Learn about design tools and workflows:** Having a basic understanding of design software and processes can help you better appreciate the designer's work and collaborate more effectively.

Assignment

Assignment: UX Evaluation & Redesign

The goal of this assignment is to help you:

- Apply **Usability Heuristics (Nielsen's 10 principles)**
- Apply **UX Laws (Hick's, Fitt's, Jakob's, etc.)**
- Develop the ability to **critically evaluate real user interfaces**
- Think like a **Product Manager / UX Designer**

Task Overview

You are required to:

1. Select any 1 digital product (Mobile app or web app)

Examples:

- Zomato / Swiggy
- Amazon / Flipkart
- Banking app
- SaaS product (like Notion, Slack, etc.)

2. Identify ONE key user flow

Examples:

- Food ordering
- Checkout
- Signup/Login
- Booking flow

3. Perform UX Evaluation

Analyze the selected flow using:

A. Usability Heuristics

- Identify at least **5 issues**

B. UX Laws

- Map at least **3 issues** to UX Laws

Submission Format: Prepare a **5–7 slide presentation (PPT / PDF)** with screenshots of the experience and in the tabular format given in next slide

Assignment Submission Format

Issue	Which Heuristic is Violated	How to Improve
All fields look similar; no clear starting point	Aesthetic & Minimalist Design	• Highlight primary fields (From, To, Date) • Use grouping or step-wise flow • Make the first action visually dominant
Date fields are red but no explanation	Visibility of System Status, Error Recovery	• Add inline error message "Please select departure date" • Highlight only when user interacts

